Columbia University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

Columbia University does not have a single AI policy dedicated exclusively to graduate theses and dissertations. Instead, it has a university-wide Generative AI Policy issued by the Office of the Provost, supplemented by school- and course-level policies. For graduate research students, the key principle is that AI use is permitted only when it aligns with academic integrity, research integrity, supervisory expectations, and any applicable publication or funding requirements. (Office of the Provost)

Key Sources

- Columbia University Generative AI Policy (Office of the Provost)
- Generative AI Guidance (Office of the Provost)
- Columbia AI Guidelines (Center for Teaching and Learning)
- Academic Integrity and AI Guidance
- Columbia Business School Generative AI Policy

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1. Policy Wording

University-wide position

Columbia's policy is intentionally permissive but cautious. The university states that it "embraces generative AI tools" while requiring that they be used in ways that account for their limitations and risks. The policy emphasizes responsible use, transparency, accountability, privacy, and academic integrity. (Office of the Provost)

For students:

> Absent a clear statement from a course instructor granting permission, the use of Generative AI tools to complete an assignment or exam is prohibited. (Office of the Provost)

For researchers:

> Individuals who use Generative AI in research must be transparent regarding its use, in describing methods, acknowledgements, or elsewhere, as appropriate. (Office of the Provost)

2. Scope of the Policy

The Provost's policy applies broadly to:

- Students
- Faculty
- Researchers
- Staff

when performing activities on behalf of Columbia University. (Office of the Provost)

The policy covers:

- Coursework and assessments
- Research activities
- Administrative work
- Data handling
- Intellectual property and unpublished research
- Security and privacy considerations (Office of the Provost)

For graduate students, this means both taught coursework and research outputs (e.g., theses, dissertations, publications, conference papers) fall within the policy framework. (Office of the Provost)

3. Approval Processes

Coursework

Columbia follows an instructor-controlled model.

Default rule

AI use is prohibited unless the instructor explicitly permits it. (Columbia College)

Approval mechanism

Faculty are expected to:

- State AI rules in the syllabus.
- Specify assignment-level permissions.
- Explain appropriate and inappropriate uses. (Columbia College)

Students are expected to:

- Read course-specific AI requirements.
- Seek clarification when policies are unclear.
- Obtain written clarification where necessary. (Students)

Research

The policy does not establish a formal university approval workflow for AI use in research.

Instead, researchers must:

- Follow supervisor expectations.
- Follow journal policies.
- Follow funder requirements.
- Follow disciplinary standards.
- Disclose AI use appropriately. (Office of the Provost)

This effectively places approval authority with supervisors, research groups, departments, ethics processes, and publication venues rather than a central university committee. (Office of the Provost)

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4. Review and Compliance Mechanisms

Coursework review

Unauthorized AI use is treated similarly to:

- Unauthorized assistance
- Plagiarism
- Academic misconduct (Columbia College)

Violations may be referred through established academic integrity and student conduct processes. (Students)

Policy review

The Provost explicitly states that the AI policy is a "work in progress" and will continue evolving as technology and university usage evolve. A Provost Working Group on Generative AI is responsible for developing and updating guidance. (Office of the Provost)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice (Thesis, Dissertation, Research Outputs)

Explicit graduate guidance

Columbia currently provides relatively little thesis-specific AI guidance compared with some universities.

However, several research principles clearly apply to graduate theses and dissertations:

Transparency

Graduate researchers must disclose AI use where appropriate in:

- Methods sections
- Acknowledgements
- Other relevant sections of research outputs (Office of the Provost)

Accuracy responsibility

Researchers remain fully responsible for:

- Facts
- Citations
- Analysis
- Conclusions
- Any AI-generated content included in the work (Office of the Provost)

The university specifically warns that AI systems can:

- Invent references
- Generate false information
- Produce misleading outputs (Office of the Provost)

Publication compliance

Graduate students preparing theses intended for publication must also comply with journal rules. Columbia notes that some journals prohibit AI-generated text, images, or figures entirely. (Office of the Provost)

Thesis examination

No publicly available Columbia policy currently identifies a separate AI review procedure for thesis examination. Examiners would instead assess work under existing standards of academic and research integrity. Based on the published guidance, responsibility for originality and accuracy remains with the student regardless of AI involvement. (Office of the Provost)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs. Content Creation

Disclosure

Columbia repeatedly emphasizes transparency.

For coursework:

- Students should disclose AI use to instructors.
- When AI use is allowed, citation and acknowledgement may be required. (Students)

For research:

- Researchers must be transparent about AI use in methods, acknowledgements, or other suitable locations. (Office of the Provost)

Editing versus content generation

Columbia does not publish a detailed university-wide distinction between:

- AI-assisted editing
- AI-assisted drafting
- AI-generated content creation

Instead, acceptability depends on:

- Instructor requirements (coursework)

- Research norms
- Journal requirements
- Supervisor expectations (Columbia College)

The policy therefore suggests a practical distinction:

Activity	General Columbia Position
Grammar checking/editing	Potentially permissible if allowed by instructor/supervisor
Brainstorming	Potentially permissible
Drafting substantive content	Requires permission or disclosure depending on context
Producing assignment answers	Prohibited unless explicitly authorized
Research writing assistance	Must be transparent and comply with publication requirements

This interpretation is derived from the university's instructor-controlled and transparency-based framework rather than an explicit Columbia table. (Columbia College)

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7. AI, Ethics, Privacy, and Intellectual Property

Columbia's guidance places strong emphasis on ethical and legal risks.

Ethics and integrity

The university identifies concerns relating to:

- Academic integrity
- Research integrity
- Bias
- Accountability
- Responsible use (Office of the Provost)

Intellectual property

The Provost specifically identifies protection of:

- Unpublished research
- Intellectual property
- Confidential information
- Clinical data

as major policy priorities. (Office of the Provost)

Privacy and security

The university warns that:

- Inputs to AI systems may become public.
- Sensitive information may be exposed.
- AI systems may create cybersecurity and privacy risks. (Office of the Provost)

Graduate researchers working with confidential datasets, human subjects data, proprietary information, or unpublished results should therefore be particularly cautious before uploading material into external AI platforms. (Office of the Provost)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Research Students

Based on Columbia's current public guidance:

1. AI use in research is not prohibited, but transparency is expected. (Office of the Provost)
2. You remain responsible for everything in your thesis, dissertation, or publication, regardless of AI assistance. (Office of the Provost)
3. Do not assume AI is allowed in coursework; instructor permission is the default requirement. (Columbia College)
4. Disclose AI use where appropriate in research outputs. (Office of the Provost)
5. Check journal, funder, and supervisor requirements before using AI in thesis drafting or publication preparation. (Office of the Provost)
6. Avoid uploading confidential, unpublished, or proprietary research materials into public AI systems. (Office of the Provost)

Yale University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

Yale has not adopted a single university-wide rule that either permits or prohibits generative AI in all academic work. Instead, Yale's approach combines university-level guidance on responsible AI use with instructor-controlled policies for coursework and discipline-specific expectations for research. The central themes are academic integrity, transparency, privacy, intellectual property protection, and researcher responsibility. (AI at Yale)

Key Official Sources

University AI Guidance

- AI at Yale – Guidance Hub
- Guidelines for the Use of Generative AI Tools (Provost-linked guidance)
- Using AI in Research (Yale Library)
- AI Review Framework

Academic Integrity

- Yale College Academic Integrity Regulations
- Handbook for Instructors – Academic Dishonesty and AI

Graduate Research

- Yale School of Public Health – Thesis/Dissertation Requirements
- Health Sciences AI Guidance

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

Yale's academic integrity regulations explicitly address AI use:

> "How and whether instructors permit you to use AI writing tools at Yale will vary widely from course to course, and is always subject to each instructor's authority and policy." (Yale University Catalog)

The same guidance advises students to check with instructors before using AI tools and not assume permission exists. Yale therefore treats AI use primarily as a course-level academic integrity issue rather than through a blanket university prohibition. (Yale University Catalog)

Research

Yale's AI guidance promotes responsible use rather than prohibition. Researchers are encouraged to evaluate AI outputs critically, understand limitations, protect data, and comply with ethical and regulatory requirements. Yale Library and AI-at-Yale resources position AI as a tool that may support research while requiring human oversight and accountability. (AI at Yale)

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2. Scope of Policy

The publicly available Yale guidance applies broadly across:

- Students
- Faculty
- Researchers
- Staff
- Administrative users of AI systems (AI at Yale)

The guidance covers:

- Coursework and assessments
- Research activities
- Data governance
- Privacy and cybersecurity
- Intellectual property protection
- Clinical and health sciences applications
- Institutional deployment of AI systems (AI at Yale)

For graduate students, this means AI use in coursework, thesis preparation, dissertations, publications, grant writing, and research data handling may all be affected by Yale guidance. (AI at Yale)

3. Approval Processes

Coursework Approval

Yale follows a highly decentralized model.

Instructor authority

The instructor determines:

- Whether AI may be used
- Which AI tools may be used
- Which assignments permit AI use
- What disclosures are required (Yale University Catalog)

Students are expected to:

- Review syllabus requirements
- Follow assignment instructions
- Seek clarification when uncertain (Yale University Catalog)

There is no published university-wide approval form or centralized authorization process for coursework AI use. (Yale University Catalog)

Research Approval

For research, approval mechanisms depend on context:

- Faculty supervisor expectations
- Research group policies
- Human subjects review requirements
- Data governance requirements
- Journal and publisher requirements
- Funding agency requirements (AI at Yale)

Health sciences research involving protected data must additionally comply with Yale privacy, security, and HIPAA-related requirements. (AI at Yale)

4. Review Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Unauthorized AI use may be addressed through Yale's established academic integrity processes. If AI use violates instructor policies, it can be treated as academic dishonesty or unauthorized assistance. (Yale University Catalog)

Institutional AI Review

Yale has established an AI governance structure and an AI Review Framework.

The framework was developed by the Yale AI Steering Committee to support oversight and evaluation of AI systems used within the university. It emphasizes:

- Trustworthiness
- Ethical compliance
- Regulatory compliance
- Risk assessment
- Governance review (AI at Yale)

While this framework primarily governs institutional AI deployment rather than student coursework, it demonstrates Yale's formal review mechanisms for AI-related risks. (AI at Yale)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis and Dissertation Expectations

Yale's published dissertation requirements continue to emphasize traditional standards:

- Original contribution to knowledge
- Mastery of methods and scholarship
- Publishable-quality work
- Scholarly originality (Yale University Catalog)

Although Yale does not currently publish a thesis-specific AI policy comparable to some universities, graduate students remain responsible for ensuring that AI use does not undermine these standards. (Yale University Catalog)

Research Outputs

Graduate students preparing:

- Journal articles
- Conference papers
- Dissertations
- Thesis manuscripts

should also comply with:

- Publisher AI policies
- Journal disclosure requirements
- Supervisor expectations
- Funding body requirements (AI at Yale)

Thesis Examination

I could not locate a publicly available Yale policy establishing a dedicated AI review process for dissertation examination.

Instead, thesis examination appears to continue under existing standards of:

- Originality
- Scholarly contribution
- Research integrity
- Academic honesty (Yale University Catalog)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs Content Creation

Disclosure

Yale's publicly available guidance consistently stresses transparency and responsible use. Research-focused guidance encourages critical evaluation of AI outputs and awareness of limitations, while instructors may impose their own disclosure requirements in courses. (AI at Yale)

Editing vs Content Creation

Yale does not currently publish a university-wide taxonomy that explicitly distinguishes between all forms of AI-assisted editing and AI-generated content creation.

However, a useful indicator comes from Yale's admissions policy, which states that using AI for:

- Grammar review
- Spelling correction
- General advice
- Topic suggestions

is distinguishable from submitting substantive AI-generated content as one's own work. (Undergraduate Admissions)

Based on Yale's broader academic integrity framework, the practical distinction is:

Use	Likely Treatment
Grammar and language polishing	Often acceptable if permitted
Brainstorming ideas	Often acceptable if permitted
Research assistance	Requires careful verification
Drafting substantive arguments or analysis	Depends on instructor/supervisor requirements
Producing assignment answers as one's own work	May constitute misconduct if unauthorized

This table reflects Yale's guidance and academic integrity principles rather than an explicit Yale policy statement. (Yale University Catalog)

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7. AI, Ethics, Privacy, and Intellectual Property

Ethics

Yale's AI guidance repeatedly emphasizes:

- Responsible use
- Trustworthy AI
- Human oversight
- Bias awareness
- Ethical deployment of AI systems (AI at Yale)

The AI Review Framework was specifically designed to ensure alignment with:

- Ethical standards
- University values
- Regulatory requirements (AI at Yale)

Intellectual Property

Yale's AI guidance warns users to protect:

- Intellectual property
- Proprietary information
- Contractually protected information
- Sensitive research materials (AI at Yale)

Privacy and Confidential Research Data

Yale places significant emphasis on privacy protection.

Researchers are advised to consider:

- Data classifications
- Confidentiality obligations
- Research participant protections
- HIPAA requirements (where applicable)
- Security risks associated with external AI systems (AI at Yale)

The health sciences guidance specifically warns that research and clinical data require careful handling before being entered into AI platforms. (AI at Yale)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

Based on Yale's current public guidance:

1. AI is not universally prohibited in research, but researchers remain fully responsible for the accuracy and integrity of their work. (AI at Yale)
2. AI use in coursework depends on instructor permission and course policies. (Yale University Catalog)
3. Graduate students should discuss AI use with supervisors before incorporating it into theses, dissertations, or publications. (AI at Yale)
4. Research outputs should follow journal, publisher, and funder disclosure requirements. (AI at Yale)
5. Sensitive research data, unpublished findings, and protected information should not be uploaded to AI systems without ensuring compliance with Yale privacy and security requirements. (AI at Yale)
6. Yale's AI governance framework places strong emphasis on ethics, transparency, risk management, and intellectual property protection. (AI at Yale)

Stanford University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

Stanford's approach to generative AI is decentralized. Rather than imposing a single university-wide prohibition or permission, Stanford places significant authority with instructors, departments, and research supervisors while grounding expectations in the Stanford Honor Code and academic integrity principles. Stanford has also developed university guidance specifically to allow experimentation with AI in teaching while maintaining academic honesty. (Office of Community Standards)

Key Official Sources

University-Wide Academic Integrity and AI

- Office of Community Standards – Generative AI Policy Guidance
- Stanford Honor Code and Community Standards
- Academic Integrity Working Group (AIWG) Guidance

Research and Responsible Use

- Stanford Research Policy Handbook
- Stanford Human-Centered AI (HAI) Resources

Graduate and Professional School Examples

- Stanford Medicine Generative AI Policy (MD/MSPA Programs)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

Stanford's Board on Conduct Affairs developed Generative AI Policy Guidance to ensure consistency with the Honor Code while allowing faculty flexibility. The university states that the purpose is:

> to give sufficient space for instructors to explore uses of generative AI tools in their courses, while providing clear guidance to students about what is and is not consistent with the Stanford Honor Code. (Office of Community Standards)

The practical effect is that AI use is determined primarily at the course level rather than through a blanket institutional rule. Departments and instructors are encouraged to establish clear and enforceable policies regarding acceptable AI use. (Stanford News)

Research

Stanford's publicly available guidance generally treats AI as a research tool whose use must remain consistent with existing standards of:

- research integrity,
- authorship,
- accuracy,
- accountability,
- responsible scholarship. (Stanford Medicine)

Researchers remain responsible for all content submitted under their names, regardless of whether AI was used during drafting, analysis, coding, or editing. (Stanford Medicine)

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2. Scope of Policy

Stanford's AI-related guidance applies across:

- Undergraduate coursework
- Graduate coursework
- Professional education
- Research activities
- Scholarly publications

- Examinations and assessments
- Administrative uses of AI (Office of Community Standards)

The AI Working Group specifically discusses:

- classroom use,
- examinations,
- assessments,
- departmental policy development,
- student learning outcomes,
- academic misconduct concerns. (Stanford News)

Graduate students are therefore subject both to course-specific AI policies and to broader research integrity obligations.

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

Stanford follows an instructor-controlled model.

Faculty may:

- permit AI use,
- partially permit AI use,
- prohibit AI use,
- require disclosure,
- design AI-inclusive assessments. (Office of Community Standards)

The Academic Integrity Working Group recommends that AI expectations be:

- reasonable,
- clearly communicated,
- consistently enforced,
- regularly discussed with students. (Stanford News)

Students should therefore not assume AI use is automatically permitted.

Research

Stanford does not appear to maintain a central university-wide approval process for AI use in research.

Instead, approval typically depends on:

- research supervisors,
- principal investigators,
- departmental expectations,
- ethics review boards,
- journal policies,
- funding-agency requirements. (Stanford Medicine)

For research involving human subjects, confidential data, clinical information, or protected information, existing Stanford review processes remain applicable regardless of whether AI tools are involved. This follows Stanford's broader research governance framework. (Stanford Medicine)

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4. Review Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Improper AI use may be reviewed through Stanford's Honor Code and academic misconduct processes. The Office of Community Standards remains responsible for enforcement of academic integrity expectations. (Office of Community Standards)

Academic Integrity Working Group

Stanford established the Academic Integrity Working Group (AIWG) in 2024 to:

- study academic dishonesty,
- examine AI-related integrity issues,
- develop guidance,
- support departments and instructors. (Stanford News)

Notably, Stanford's AIWG advises caution regarding AI-detection software because of:

- false positives,
- false negatives,
- bias concerns,
- inability to reliably determine the extent of AI involvement. (Stanford News)

As a result, Stanford discourages reliance on AI detectors as evidence in high-stakes misconduct proceedings. (Stanford News)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice (Theses, Dissertations, Publications)

Thesis and Dissertation Preparation

Stanford does not currently publish a university-wide dissertation-specific AI policy comparable to some institutions.

However, existing guidance implies several expectations for graduate students:

Responsibility remains with the student

Graduate researchers remain responsible for:

- factual accuracy,
- analysis,
- conclusions,
- citations,
- originality of scholarly contribution. (Stanford Medicine)

Disclosure is expected when appropriate

Stanford Medicine's AI policy provides one of the clearest examples of institutional expectations and requires documentation of:

- AI tool used,
- model/version,
- prompt/query,
- date of use,
- relevant output utilized. (Stanford Medicine)

Although written for MD/MSPA programs, this provides insight into Stanford's broader approach to transparency.

AI cannot be an author

Stanford Medicine explicitly states:

> AI tools may not be listed as authors on scholarly works. (Stanford Medicine)

This aligns with major academic publisher policies and is highly relevant for graduate publications.

Thesis Examination

I could not identify a publicly available Stanford policy establishing a separate AI-review stage for thesis or dissertation examination.

Instead, examination appears to continue under traditional standards:

- originality,
- scholarly merit,
- research integrity,
- academic honesty. (Office of Community Standards)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs Content Creation

Stanford generally emphasizes transparency rather than outright prohibition.

Editing Uses

Examples that may be permitted depending on instructor or supervisor approval include:

- grammar correction,
- language editing,
- summarization,
- brainstorming,
- coding assistance. (Stanford News)

Content Creation

More substantial uses such as:

- drafting assignment responses,
- generating essays,
- producing analysis,

- writing major portions of research outputs

are subject to instructor, supervisor, department, or publication requirements. (Stanford News)

Disclosure Expectations

The clearest Stanford language comes from Stanford Medicine:

AI-assisted work should identify:

- tool name,
- model version,
- date used,
- prompt,
- output incorporated. (Stanford Medicine)

This represents one of the more detailed disclosure models currently published within Stanford.

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7. AI, Ethics, Privacy, and Intellectual Property

Ethics

Stanford's AI guidance consistently emphasizes:

- responsible use,
- academic integrity,
- bias awareness,
- critical evaluation of outputs,
- AI literacy. (Stanford Medicine)

The Stanford Medicine policy specifically requires students to understand:

- hallucinations,
- bias,
- limitations,
- privacy risks associated with AI systems. (Stanford Medicine)

Intellectual Property

While Stanford's AI guidance is still evolving, researchers are expected to comply with existing university policies governing:

- intellectual property,
- ownership of research outputs,
- confidential information,
- unpublished research. (Stanford Medicine)

Graduate researchers should be particularly cautious when uploading:

- unpublished manuscripts,
- proprietary datasets,
- sponsor-funded research,
- confidential materials

into external AI systems.

Privacy and Data Protection

Stanford's guidance highlights the need to understand privacy risks associated with AI platforms. This is especially important for:

- human-subjects research,
- medical data,
- protected health information,
- confidential research records. (Stanford Medicine)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Research Students

Based on Stanford's publicly available guidance:

1. AI use is generally governed by instructor, department, and supervisor expectations rather than a single university-wide rule. (Office of Community Standards)
2. Graduate researchers remain fully responsible for all thesis, dissertation, and publication content. (Stanford Medicine)
3. Transparency and disclosure of AI use are strongly encouraged and, in some Stanford programs, explicitly required. (Stanford Medicine)
4. AI systems cannot be credited as authors. (Stanford Medicine)

5. AI detection tools are not considered sufficiently reliable for high-stakes misconduct determinations. (Stanford News)
6. Graduate students should consult supervisors and journal policies before using AI in thesis drafting, manuscript preparation, or publication activities. (Stanford Medicine)
7. Confidential, unpublished, or sensitive research information should not be uploaded to external AI systems without appropriate approval and safeguards. (Stanford Medicine)

Princeton University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

Princeton University has adopted a **principles-based, instructor-directed approach** to generative AI. Rather than imposing a single blanket rule across all teaching and research, Princeton places responsibility on students to follow course and departmental policies, disclose AI use when permitted, and uphold academic integrity under Princeton's *Rights, Rules, and Responsibilities* framework. The University has also begun issuing graduate-specific guidance through departments and scholarly integrity resources. (Scholarly Integrity)

Key Official Sources

University-Wide Guidance

- Princeton Scholarly Integrity – Disclosing Generative AI Use
- Generative AI at Princeton (OIT)
- Generative AI Tools Use Policy

Graduate-Specific Guidance

- History Department Graduate Student Generative AI Policy

Research Resources

- AI Resources for Research (Office of the Dean for Research)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

Princeton's central academic integrity guidance places responsibility on students to understand and comply with course-specific AI rules:

> "Students are responsible for familiarizing themselves with and adhering to course and departmental policies regarding the use of generative AI." (Scholarly Integrity)

The same policy identifies the following as potential academic integrity violations:

- Directly copying AI output.
- Presenting AI-generated work as one's own.
- Exceeding instructor-authorized uses.
- Failing to disclose AI use when required. (Scholarly Integrity)

Unlike some universities that have adopted default permissions or prohibitions, Princeton leaves substantial discretion to instructors and departments. (Scholarly Integrity)

Research

Princeton's research-facing guidance treats AI as a potentially valuable research tool while emphasizing responsible use, verification, and transparency. The University's AI resources highlight AI's role in teaching, learning, and research while cautioning users about limitations, risks, and the need for oversight. (Office of Information Technology)

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2. Scope of Policy

Princeton's AI-related guidance applies across:

- Undergraduate coursework
- Graduate coursework
- Independent research projects
- Theses and dissertations
- Research activities
- Teaching and learning
- Administrative uses of AI (Office of Information Technology)

Importantly, the Scholarly Integrity guidance applies to all academic work, while departmental policies may establish stricter requirements for graduate students and research outputs. (Scholarly Integrity)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

Princeton follows an instructor-controlled model.

The University states that students will encounter:

- Courses where AI is prohibited.
- Courses where limited use is permitted.
- Courses encouraging experimentation with AI. (Scholarly Integrity)

The first responsibility of a student is therefore:

> determine whether, how, and to what extent a given course allows you to use generative AI. (Scholarly Integrity)

Approval occurs through:

- Course syllabi.
- Assignment instructions.
- Instructor guidance.
- Departmental policies. (Scholarly Integrity)

Research

There is no publicly available university-wide approval form for AI use in research.

Instead, approval generally occurs through:

- Faculty advisers.
- Dissertation supervisors.
- Departmental expectations.
- Research ethics processes.
- Journal and publisher requirements. (Department of History)

The History Department policy explicitly requires consultation with advisers before certain AI-assisted research uses are undertaken after advancement to candidacy. (Department of History)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Improper AI use is reviewed through Princeton's academic integrity framework.

Examples of violations include:

- Submitting AI-generated work as original work.
- Using AI beyond authorized limits.
- Failing to disclose AI use when required. (Scholarly Integrity)

AI Governance

Princeton has established an institutional AI governance structure through its Artificial Intelligence Program Committee.

Its responsibilities include:

- Developing AI policies.
- Reviewing AI use cases.
- Assessing risks.
- Providing oversight on compliance, security, legal, and governance matters. (Office of Information Technology)

However, this committee primarily governs administrative and operational AI deployment rather than individual student coursework. (Office of Information Technology)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Among Ivy League universities, Princeton is notable for publishing a department-level graduate AI policy with substantial detail.

Graduate Coursework and Early Doctoral Training

The History Department strongly advises against most AI use during the first two years of doctoral training.

The rationale is that graduate students must personally develop:

- Reading skills.
- Research skills.
- Historical interpretation.
- Writing ability.
- Language proficiency.
- Critical analysis. (Department of History)

The policy specifically states that students should not:

- Use AI to do assigned reading.
- Use AI to write coursework.
- Use AI to translate work that students should themselves translate.
- Paste AI-generated text into assignments. (Department of History)

Dissertation Preparation

After advancement to candidacy, Princeton recognizes that some AI uses may become appropriate.

Examples include:

- Organizing archives.
- Managing digital libraries.
- Transcribing materials.
- Compiling large datasets.
- Standardizing footnotes. (Department of History)

However, Princeton emphasizes that AI should function like a research assistant rather than a scholarly author, and all outputs must be checked for errors. (Department of History)

Dissertation Outputs and Publications

The History Department states that AI contributions should be:

> openly acknowledged in your dissertation and publications. (Department of History)

This is one of the clearest graduate-level disclosure expectations published by any Princeton department. (Department of History)

Thesis Examination

I could not identify a publicly available Princeton-wide policy establishing a dedicated AI review stage during thesis or dissertation examination.

Instead, examination appears to remain governed by traditional standards of:

- Original scholarship.
- Research integrity.
- Academic honesty.
- Intellectual contribution. (Scholarly Integrity)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs. Content Creation

Disclosure Requirements

Princeton's Scholarly Integrity guidance is unusually explicit:

> If generative AI is permitted by the instructor ... students must disclose its use. (Scholarly Integrity)

Princeton distinguishes disclosure from citation because:

> generative AI is not a source. (Scholarly Integrity)

The University therefore expects disclosure statements rather than conventional references or bibliographic citations. (Scholarly Integrity)

Editing vs. Content Creation

Princeton does not publish a university-wide taxonomy, but available guidance allows some distinctions.

Potentially Acceptable (if permitted)

- Brainstorming.
- Clarification questions.
- Feedback on writing.
- Grammar review.
- Organizational assistance. (Department of History)

Generally Prohibited

- Copying AI-generated text.
- Submitting AI-generated writing as one's own.
- Using AI to replace required reading or analysis.
- Delegating interpretation, argumentation, or scholarly writing to AI. (Department of History)

The History Department is particularly explicit that AI should never replace:

- Interpretation.
- Argumentation.
- Primary source analysis.
- Scholarly writing. (Department of History)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

Princeton's guidance emphasizes:

- Academic integrity.
- Transparency.
- Responsible use.
- Human accountability.
- Verification of outputs. (Scholarly Integrity)

Graduate students are warned that relying on AI for intellectual work can undermine both educational development and scholarly ethics. (Department of History)

Intellectual Property

Princeton's AI guidance treats AI-generated output differently from traditional scholarly sources and requires disclosure rather than citation. The University also emphasizes careful handling of institutional information and unpublished work. (Scholarly Integrity)

Privacy and Confidential Information

Princeton's Generative AI Tools Use Policy requires that:

- Only University-licensed AI tools be used with certain institutional information.
- Public AI systems not be used with protected University data.
- Confidential information be safeguarded. (Office of Information Technology)

Although the administrative policy does not directly govern academic research data, it reflects Princeton's broader concern about privacy, security, and information governance when using AI systems. (Office of Information Technology)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. Princeton permits AI use only within the limits set by instructors, departments, and advisers. (Scholarly Integrity)
2. Disclosure of AI use is expected whenever AI use is authorized. (Scholarly Integrity)
3. AI-generated text should not be submitted as original scholarly work. (Scholarly Integrity)
4. Graduate students should consult advisers before using AI in dissertation research workflows. (Department of History)
5. Princeton's strongest graduate-specific guidance allows AI for administrative research tasks (e.g., transcription, organization, footnote standardization) but not for interpretation, argumentation, or scholarly writing. (Department of History)
6. AI contributions to dissertations and publications should be openly acknowledged. (Department of History)
7. Researchers remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of all submitted work, regardless of AI assistance. (Department of History)

Harvard University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

Harvard University has adopted a **decentralized, school-based approach** to generative AI rather than a single university-wide academic policy governing all coursework, theses, dissertations, and research outputs. The University provides overarching guidance emphasizing **academic integrity, transparency, privacy, security, copyright, and responsible use**, while individual schools, instructors, departments, and research supervisors determine many of the operational rules. (HUIT)

Key Official Sources

University-Wide AI Guidance

- Generative AI @ Harvard
- Guidelines for Using ChatGPT and other Generative AI Tools at Harvard (Office of the Provost)
- Harvard University Information Technology (HUIT) Generative AI Guidelines

Research Guidance

- Research with Generative AI (Harvard)

Teaching and Coursework Guidance

- Learn with Generative AI (Students)
- Office of Undergraduate Education – Generative AI Guidance

School-Specific Examples

- Harvard Graduate School of Education AI Policy
- Harvard Medical School Responsible Use of Generative AI

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1. Policy Wording

University-Level Position

Harvard's central guidance states:

> "The University supports responsible experimentation with generative AI tools." (HUIT)

At the same time, Harvard emphasizes several risks:

- Information security
- Data privacy
- Compliance
- Copyright
- Academic integrity
- Accuracy and hallucinations (HUIT)

Harvard's AI resources repeatedly stress that users remain responsible for the content they submit, publish, or rely upon. AI assistance does not transfer responsibility from the student or researcher. (HUIT)

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2. Scope of Policy

Harvard's AI guidance applies broadly to:

- Undergraduate coursework
- Graduate coursework

- Master's programs
- Doctoral research
- Theses and dissertations
- Publications
- Grant applications
- Administrative work
- Research activities (Harvard University)

Because Harvard operates through multiple schools, individual schools may impose additional requirements. Harvard explicitly directs students to consult school-specific policies and guidance. (Harvard University)

Examples include:

- Harvard Graduate School of Education
- Harvard Medical School
- Harvard Kenneth C. Griffin Graduate School of Arts and Sciences (Harvard University)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

Harvard's dominant model is **instructor authority**.

The Faculty of Arts and Sciences requires instructors to communicate AI expectations to students:

> "All faculty are required to inform students of the policies governing generative AI use in class." (Office of Undergraduate Education)

As a result:

- Some instructors prohibit AI.
- Some permit limited use.
- Some integrate AI into learning activities.
- Disclosure requirements may vary by course. (Office of Undergraduate Education)

Students are expected to review course-specific rules before using AI. (Harvard University)

Research

Harvard does not appear to have a university-wide approval form for AI use in research.

Instead, approval and oversight generally occur through:

- Faculty advisers
- Dissertation supervisors
- Principal investigators
- Research ethics boards (where applicable)
- Journal policies
- Publisher policies
- Funding agency requirements (Harvard University)

Harvard's research guidance specifically advises researchers to review publisher and funder requirements before using AI in scholarly work. (Harvard University)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Improper AI use may be handled through existing academic integrity procedures.

Harvard's guidance consistently links AI use to:

- Academic honesty
- Original work
- Student responsibility
- Appropriate attribution and disclosure (Harvard University)

Violations are therefore typically addressed through school-level academic misconduct processes rather than a separate AI disciplinary framework. (Harvard Registrar)

Ongoing Policy Review

Harvard's Provost guidance explicitly notes that AI guidance is evolving:

> "The University will continue to monitor developments and incorporate feedback ... to update our guidelines accordingly." (Harvard Provost)

This means AI policies are expected to be periodically revised as technology and academic practices evolve. (Harvard Provost)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis and Dissertation Preparation

Harvard currently provides limited university-wide dissertation-specific AI rules.

However, several research principles clearly apply to graduate students:

Responsibility

Graduate students remain responsible for:

- Analysis
- Interpretation
- Citations
- Conclusions
- Scholarly originality
- Research integrity (Harvard University)

Verification

Harvard repeatedly warns that AI systems can:

- Hallucinate facts
- Invent references
- Misrepresent evidence
- Generate inaccurate content (HUIT)

Graduate researchers are expected to independently verify all AI-assisted outputs. (HMS IT)

Research Outputs and Publications

Harvard's research guidance is unusually explicit regarding publications:

Disclosure

Harvard states:

> "Most academic publishers require researchers using AI tools to document this use in the methods or acknowledgements sections of their papers." (Harvard University)

Researchers should therefore review:

- Journal policies
- Publisher policies
- Professional society requirements

before submitting papers, dissertations intended for publication, or conference proceedings. (Harvard University)

Thesis Examination

I could not locate a publicly available Harvard-wide policy creating a separate AI-review stage for thesis or dissertation examinations.

Current public guidance suggests that graduate examinations continue to be assessed using traditional standards:

- Originality
- Scholarly contribution
- Research integrity
- Academic honesty (Harvard University)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs. Content Creation

Disclosure

Harvard strongly favors transparency.

For research outputs:

Researchers using AI tools should document that use when required by publishers. (Harvard University)

For coursework:

Disclosure requirements are usually determined by instructors and schools. (Office of Undergraduate Education)

Editing vs. Content Creation

Harvard does not currently publish a university-wide framework formally categorizing all AI uses.

However, available guidance supports the following distinctions:

Activity	Typical Harvard Treatment
Grammar correction	Often permissible if allowed by instructor
Editing and polishing	Often permissible if disclosed when required
Brainstorming ideas	Frequently allowed in some courses
Research assistance	Allowed subject to verification
Drafting substantive content	Depends on instructor, supervisor, or publisher rules
Producing assignment answers	May violate course policies if unauthorized
Writing major portions of a thesis or article	Requires careful review of supervisor and publisher expectations

This table reflects Harvard's decentralized policy structure rather than a formal Harvard classification. (Office of Undergraduate Education)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

Harvard consistently emphasizes:

- Responsible use
- Academic integrity
- Human accountability
- Verification of outputs
- Transparency
- Professional judgment (Harvard University)

The University's AI guidance warns users not to rely uncritically on AI-generated information. (HUIT)

Intellectual Property and Copyright

Harvard's Provost and HUIT guidance specifically identify copyright and compliance concerns as major AI risks. (HUIT)

Researchers and students are expected to consider:

- Copyright implications
- Ownership of research outputs
- Licensing restrictions
- Publisher requirements (HUIT)

Privacy and Confidential Research Data

One of Harvard's strongest AI directives concerns confidential information.

Harvard states:

> "You should not enter data classified as confidential ... including non-public research data ... into publicly-available generative AI tools." (HUIT)

Examples include:

- Unpublished research data
- Human-subjects data
- Student records
- Medical information
- Proprietary research materials (HUIT)

Confidential information may only be used in approved AI environments that have undergone Harvard security and privacy review. (HUIT)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. Harvard does **not** have a single university-wide rule governing AI use in all coursework and research; many decisions are made at the school, department, instructor, and supervisor levels. (Harvard University)
2. Students and researchers remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of their work, regardless of AI assistance. (HUIT)
3. Graduate researchers should consult advisers before using AI in thesis, dissertation, or publication workflows. (Harvard University)
4. AI use in scholarly publications should generally be disclosed when required by publishers or journals. (Harvard University)
5. Harvard places particularly strong emphasis on protecting confidential and unpublished research data from public AI systems. (HUIT)
6. AI-assisted editing and brainstorming may be acceptable in some contexts, but substantive content generation is subject to instructor, supervisor, school, and publisher requirements. (Office of Undergraduate Education)
7. Ethical use, academic integrity, transparency, copyright compliance, and privacy protection are the core principles underlying Harvard's AI guidance. (HUIT)

University of Toronto: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

The University of Toronto (U of T) has adopted a **permission-based approach to generative AI in coursework** and a **supervisor-approved, transparency-based approach in graduate research**. While there is no single university-wide AI policy covering every academic activity, U of T has issued institutional guidance, academic integrity rules, and (most notably) detailed School of Graduate Studies (SGS) guidance for graduate milestones, including theses and doctoral examinations. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

Key Official Sources

Coursework and Academic Integrity

Generative AI and Academic Integrity (U of T Mississauga)

Generative AI and Academic Integrity

Using ChatGPT or Other AI Tools on a Marked Assessment

Academic Integrity – Using ChatGPT or Other AI Tools

UTSC Academic Integrity Handbook

UTSC Academic Integrity & Generative AI

Graduate Research and Thesis Guidance

School of Graduate Studies (SGS)

Guidance on the Appropriate Use of Generative AI for Graduate Academic Milestones

Institutional Framework

University AI Task Force / Institutional Framework

Generative AI Institutional Framework

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

U of T's publicly available academic integrity guidance is unusually explicit:

> "Students are not allowed to use generative AI in a course unless the instructor explicitly permits it." (University of Toronto Mississauga)

This establishes a **default prohibition model**:

- AI use is not automatically permitted.
- Permission must come from the instructor.
- Students must follow any conditions attached to that permission.
- Unauthorized use may constitute academic misconduct. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

The University further states that using generative AI when not authorized may be considered the use of an "unauthorized aid" under the Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters. (University of Toronto Scarborough)

Graduate Research

The School of Graduate Studies (SGS) has issued dedicated guidance addressing:

- comprehensive examinations,
- candidacy requirements,
- language requirements,
- doctoral theses,
- final oral examinations,
- graduate research and scholarly writing. (School of Graduate Studies)

SGS states that students should:

> seek and document in writing unambiguous approval from their supervisor(s) and supervisory committee in advance of the use of generative AI tools. (School of Graduate Studies)

This is among the most detailed graduate-specific AI guidance published by a major North American university. (School of Graduate Studies)

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2. Scope of Policy

The guidance applies across:

Coursework

- Essays
- Assignments
- Projects
- Exams
- Term tests
- Course assessments (University of Toronto Mississauga)

Graduate Academic Milestones

The SGS guidance specifically covers:

- Comprehensive examinations
- Candidacy milestones
- Language examinations
- Master's theses
- Doctoral dissertations
- Final oral examinations
- Research outputs related to degree requirements (School of Graduate Studies)

Research Activities

The guidance also addresses AI use in:

- Searching
- Designing research
- Outlining
- Drafting
- Writing
- Editing
- Producing visual and audio materials
- Other scholarly activities (School of Graduate Studies)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework Approval

The approval model is instructor-centered.

Students are instructed to:

1. Check the syllabus.
2. Review assignment instructions.
3. Follow any AI-specific requirements.
4. Ask the instructor if uncertain. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

U of T warns that policies may differ:

> do not assume that an instructor will have the same policy on generative AI for all of the courses they teach. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

Graduate Research Approval

For graduate research, U of T requires a much higher level of oversight.

SGS recommends:

- Prior written approval from supervisors.
- Prior written approval from supervisory committees.
- Documentation of the approval process. (School of Graduate Studies)

This applies when AI is used in:

- Research design
- Literature searching
- Thesis drafting
- Editing
- Scholarly outputs
- Graduate milestone assessments (School of Graduate Studies)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Unauthorized AI use may be investigated under the University's Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters.

The Code treats use of an unauthorized aid or unauthorized assistance as an academic offence. (University of Toronto Scarborough)

Potential consequences therefore fall under existing academic misconduct procedures rather than a separate AI disciplinary framework. (Academic Integrity)

Research Misconduct Review

SGS guidance goes beyond academic integrity and explicitly references:

- the Policy on Ethical Conduct in Research;
- the Framework to Address Allegations of Research Misconduct. (School of Graduate Studies)

Accordingly, inappropriate AI use in research may potentially be reviewed as research misconduct rather than merely coursework misconduct. (School of Graduate Studies)

Institutional Review

U of T established an AI Task Force to develop institutional recommendations regarding AI in:

- teaching,
- learning,
- research,
- administration,
- governance. (University of Toronto Scarborough)

The Task Force emphasizes a human-centred approach and continuing policy development. (University of Toronto Scarborough)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis Preparation

The SGS guidance directly addresses AI use in thesis preparation.

Graduate students are advised that:

- AI may generate inaccurate content.
- AI may fabricate references.
- AI may reproduce bias.
- AI-generated material may fail to meet research integrity standards. (School of Graduate Studies)

Most importantly:

> Students remain responsible for the content of their thesis and other academic works. (School of Graduate Studies)

Comprehensive Exams and Candidacy

The guidance explicitly includes:

- Comprehensive examinations
- Candidacy requirements
- Language requirements (School of Graduate Studies)

Students are expected to obtain approval before using AI in connection with these milestones. (School of Graduate Studies)

Doctoral Thesis and Final Oral Examination

The SGS document specifically names:

- Doctoral thesis preparation
- Final oral examinations (thesis defence) (School of Graduate Studies)

Although no separate AI examination stage exists, AI use associated with these milestones is expected to be:

- approved,
- documented,
- transparent,
- consistent with research integrity standards. (School of Graduate Studies)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs. Content Creation

Disclosure Requirements

U of T's guidance strongly emphasizes transparency.

SGS states that:

careful attention must be paid to appropriate citation and description of the use of generative AI tools. (School of Graduate Studies)

The guidance indicates disclosure may be required for AI use in:

- searching,
- designing,
- outlining,
- drafting,
- writing,
- editing,
- creating visual or audio content. (School of Graduate Studies)

Editing vs Content Creation

The SGS guidance is notable because it explicitly includes both editing and content generation activities.

Examples requiring consideration, approval, and disclosure may include:

Editing-Type Uses

- Language editing
- Rewriting
- Organizational assistance
- Draft refinement (School of Graduate Studies)

Content-Creation Uses

- Drafting text
- Producing written content
- Creating images
- Producing audio content
- Designing research materials (School of Graduate Studies)

The guidance does not create a blanket distinction where editing is automatically acceptable and content creation automatically prohibited. Instead, both require oversight, approval, and transparency. (School of Graduate Studies)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

The University repeatedly frames AI use through:

- Academic integrity
- Research integrity
- Transparency
- Accountability
- Human responsibility (University of Toronto Mississauga)

Students are warned that AI:

- can hallucinate,
- can reproduce bias,
- may generate offensive content,
- may undermine scholarly originality. (School of Graduate Studies)

Intellectual Property

While the SGS guidance does not establish a standalone AI-IP policy, it emphasizes:

- Proper citation
- Proper attribution
- Disclosure of AI use
- Compliance with disciplinary norms and publication requirements (School of Graduate Studies)

Researchers are expected to comply with journal and disciplinary expectations concerning AI-assisted content. (School of Graduate Studies)

Privacy and Confidential Information

U of T's academic integrity guidance advises:

Do not input any private, confidential or identifying information into generative AI. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

The University warns that information entered into AI systems may be retained and reused. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

This is particularly important for graduate researchers handling:

- human-subject data,
- confidential datasets,
- unpublished research,
- personal information,
- sensitive institutional information. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. **Coursework:** AI is prohibited unless an instructor explicitly authorizes its use. (University of Toronto Mississauga)
2. **Graduate research:** U of T SGS recommends obtaining written approval from supervisors and supervisory committees before using AI in research, theses, comprehensive exams, or other graduate milestones. (School of Graduate Studies)
3. **Disclosure:** AI use should be transparently described and documented, including uses involving searching, outlining, drafting, writing, and editing. (School of Graduate Studies)
4. **Responsibility:** Students remain fully responsible for all thesis, dissertation, and examination content, regardless of AI assistance. (School of Graduate Studies)
5. **Review mechanisms:** Unauthorized AI use may trigger academic misconduct proceedings, while inappropriate AI use in research may raise research misconduct concerns. (School of Graduate Studies)
6. **Thesis and defence:** AI use in doctoral theses and final oral examinations falls within SGS guidance and should be approved and documented in advance. (School of Graduate Studies)
7. **Privacy and ethics:** Do not upload confidential research, personal information, or unpublished data to public AI systems. Verify all AI outputs independently. (University of Toronto Mississauga)

McGill University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

McGill University has adopted a **mixed model**: coursework-related AI use is generally governed by instructors and course policies, while graduate research is governed by formal guidance from Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies (GPS). McGill has developed some of the more detailed Canadian guidance on AI in graduate research, including thesis-specific disclosure expectations and supervisor oversight requirements. (McGill University)

Key Official Sources

Graduate Research and Theses

- Guidelines on Using Generative AI in Research (GPS)
- Use of Generative AI for Research (GPS Thesis Guidance)

Teaching and Coursework

- Generative AI for Teaching and Learning at McGill
- Using Generative AI in Teaching and Learning

Institutional Guidance

- McGill AI Guidelines (IT Services)
- STL Recommendations on Generative AI

Academic Integrity

- McGill Academic Integrity Regulations

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

McGill has not established a single university-wide rule that either universally permits or prohibits AI use in coursework. Instead, the university's teaching and learning guidance encourages instructors to establish explicit AI policies within their courses. The STL Working Group recommended that AI use be guided in ways that support academic rigor, privacy, and academic integrity. (McGill University)

McGill's academic integrity regulations continue to apply regardless of whether AI is involved. Unauthorized assistance, plagiarism, and cheating remain academic offences. (McGill Course Catalogue)

Research

GPS has issued dedicated guidance for graduate students:

> "GPS has developed comprehensive guidelines for graduate students on using generative AI in research." (McGill University)

The guidance is specifically research-focused and addresses both appropriate uses and limitations of AI tools in scholarly work. (McGill University)

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2. Scope of Policy

Coursework

McGill's teaching guidance applies to:

- Assignments
- Essays
- Projects
- Exams and assessments
- Teaching and learning activities
- Course-specific academic work (Teaching and Learning Knowledge Base)

Research and Graduate Degrees

GPS guidance applies to:

- Master's research
- Doctoral research
- Theses
- Dissertations
- Scholarly publications
- Research data analysis
- Literature reviews
- Academic writing associated with research degrees (McGill University)

The university explicitly notes that the GPS guidance is **research-focused rather than course-based**. (McGill University)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

McGill generally leaves decisions about AI use to instructors and programs.

The Teaching and Learning resources provide examples of course-outline statements that instructors can adopt, reflecting varying levels of permission or restriction. (Teaching and Learning Knowledge Base)

As a practical matter, students should:

- Check course outlines.
- Review assignment instructions.
- Seek clarification from instructors if uncertain. (Teaching and Learning Knowledge Base)

Graduate Research

GPS explicitly recommends discussion with supervisors:

> Students with questions on using generative AI in research are encouraged to discuss this topic with their supervisors and graduate program directors. (McGill University)

The research guidance therefore adopts a supervisor-governed model rather than a blanket approval or prohibition framework. (McGill University)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Improper AI use may be addressed through existing academic integrity procedures.

McGill's regulations continue to prohibit:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating
- Unauthorized assistance
- Use of unauthorized materials in examinations (McGill Course Catalogue)

AI-related misconduct would typically be handled under these existing frameworks rather than through a separate AI disciplinary process. (McGill Course Catalogue)

Institutional Oversight

McGill established the STL AI Working Group to develop recommendations regarding generative AI in teaching and learning. These recommendations were subsequently approved by university governance bodies. (McGill University)

The Working Group's mandate includes:

- Supporting instructors and students.
- Providing guidance.
- Addressing privacy concerns.
- Promoting academic integrity.
- Evaluating AI's role in higher education. (McGill University)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis Preparation

McGill is one of the few universities that has published graduate-specific AI guidance through GPS.

GPS has developed:

- Research-use guidance.
- Thesis disclosure guidance.
- A framework for documenting AI use in theses. (McGill University)

Notably, GPS announced:

> "GenAI Research Statement and Disclosure Guidelines for Theses." (McGill University)

These guidelines are intended for master's and doctoral theses and provide a framework for transparency regarding AI use. (McGill University)

Thesis Outputs

Graduate students are expected to:

- Discuss AI use with supervisors.
- Understand AI limitations.
- Appropriately disclose AI involvement.
- Ensure research integrity standards are maintained. (McGill University)

Thesis Examination

I could not identify a publicly available McGill policy establishing a separate AI-specific thesis examination procedure.

Current evidence suggests theses continue to be evaluated according to traditional standards:

- Original scholarship
- Research quality
- Academic rigor
- Research integrity (McGill University)

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6. Disclosure and Use: Editing vs. Content Creation

Disclosure

McGill's GPS guidance places significant emphasis on disclosure.

The introduction of thesis-specific disclosure frameworks indicates that graduate students are expected to be transparent about AI use in research and thesis preparation. (McGill University)

The GPS thesis guidance specifically refers to a recommended statement and disclosure framework for master's and doctoral theses. (McGill University)

Editing vs. Content Creation

McGill's publicly available guidance generally does not establish a strict university-wide distinction between editing and content creation.

However, the GPS guidance emphasizes understanding:

- How AI was used.
- Its limitations.
- Appropriate disclosure.
- Research integrity implications. (McGill University)

The practical interpretation is:

Use Type	Likely Treatment
Grammar correction	Potentially acceptable with appropriate oversight
Language editing	Potentially acceptable with disclosure where required
Brainstorming	Potentially acceptable
Literature exploration	Potentially acceptable with verification
Drafting substantive research content	Requires careful supervisor oversight
Producing original scholarly arguments	Subject to research integrity expectations and disclosure

This table reflects McGill's guidance themes rather than a formal GPS classification. (McGill University)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

McGill explicitly states that AI should be used:

> "responsibly, ethically, and securely." (McGill University)

The STL recommendations identify concerns involving:

- Academic integrity
- Intellectual production
- Responsibility
- Ethical principles
- Privacy protection (McGill University)

Intellectual Property

McGill's IT Services guidance specifically addresses copyright:

Users should:

- Use their own content.
- Use publicly available content.
- Avoid material where permission has not been granted by copyright holders. (McGill University)

The STL report also recognizes generative AI's implications for:

- Creativity
- Intellectual property
- Ownership of intellectual work (McGill University)

Privacy and Confidential Information

McGill's AI Guidelines contain explicit privacy safeguards.

The university recommends:

- Removing personally identifying information.
- Avoiding use of sensitive data.
- Seeking approval when sensitive information is involved. (McGill University)

McGill specifically states that:

- Personal Health Information (PHI) is prohibited.
- Payment Card Industry (PCI) data is prohibited. (McGill University)

Researchers should therefore avoid entering:

- Confidential research data
- Human-subject information
- Health information
- Unpublished sensitive materials

into public AI systems. (McGill University)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. McGill does **not** operate under a single university-wide coursework AI policy; instructors generally determine permissible uses in their courses. (Teaching and Learning Knowledge Base)
2. Graduate research is governed by formal GPS guidance specifically addressing AI use in research. (McGill University)
3. Students are encouraged to discuss AI use with supervisors and graduate program directors before incorporating AI into research workflows. (McGill University)
4. McGill has introduced thesis-specific AI disclosure guidance for master's and doctoral theses. (McGill University)
5. AI-related academic misconduct is generally reviewed under existing academic integrity procedures rather than through a separate AI discipline process. (McGill Course Catalogue)
6. Researchers remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of all thesis and publication content, regardless of AI assistance. (McGill University)
7. McGill places strong emphasis on ethical AI use, copyright compliance, transparency, and protection of sensitive or personal information. (McGill University)

University of British Columbia (UBC): AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

UBC has adopted a **principles-based and decentralized approach** to generative AI. There is no single university-wide rule that universally permits or prohibits AI use in coursework, theses, dissertations, or research. Instead, UBC relies on existing academic integrity and research integrity frameworks, supplemented by guidance from the Office of the Provost, the Centre for Teaching, Learning and Technology (CTLT), UBC Library, Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies (G+PS), and individual instructors, supervisors, departments, and faculties.

Key Official Sources

University-Wide AI Guidance

Generative AI at UBC

Generative AI at UBC

CTLT – Generative AI and Teaching

CTLT Generative AI Resources

Academic Integrity and Generative AI

UBC Academic Integrity and Generative AI

Graduate Research and Thesis Guidance

Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies (G+PS) – Generative AI Guidance

G+PS Generative AI Guidance

Research Ethics and Integrity

UBC Research Integrity

UBC Research Integrity

Research Ethics

UBC Research Ethics

1. Policy Wording

Coursework

UBC does not impose a university-wide prohibition on AI use.

Instead, the University emphasizes that:

> students must follow instructor expectations regarding the use of generative AI.

The Academic Integrity Office notes that whether AI use is permitted depends on the assessment, course, and instructor requirements.

The central principle is that students must not use AI in ways that constitute unauthorized assistance or misrepresentation of authorship.

Source:
UBC Academic Integrity and Generative AI

Graduate Research

Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies (G+PS) states that graduate students remain responsible for all work submitted toward degree requirements, regardless of whether AI tools were used.

The guidance emphasizes:

- transparency,
- accountability,
- scholarly integrity,
- supervisory consultation,
- compliance with disciplinary norms.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

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2. Scope of Policy

The guidance applies broadly across:

Coursework

- Assignments
- Essays
- Reports
- Presentations
- Projects
- Examinations
- Online assessments

Source:
UBC Academic Integrity and Generative AI

Graduate Research

G+PS guidance applies to:

- Master's theses
- Doctoral dissertations
- Comprehensive examinations
- Research proposals
- Scholarly publications
- Conference papers
- Graduate research outputs

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

The approval model is instructor-driven.

Students are expected to:

1. Review the syllabus.
2. Review assignment instructions.
3. Follow any AI-related requirements.
4. Ask instructors when expectations are unclear.

UBC explicitly recognizes that AI permissions may differ across courses and assessments.

Source:
[CTLT Generative AI Resources]

Graduate Research

G+PS strongly encourages graduate students to discuss AI use with:

- supervisors,
- supervisory committees,
- graduate programs.

The guidance emphasizes that acceptable AI use may vary by discipline and project.

Graduate students are expected to obtain guidance before incorporating AI into significant aspects of research or thesis preparation.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

Improper AI use may be reviewed under UBC's academic misconduct procedures.

Examples include:

- unauthorized assistance,
- plagiarism,
- misrepresentation of authorship,

- submission of non-original work.

UBC treats AI-related misconduct through existing academic integrity frameworks rather than through a separate AI disciplinary process.

Source:
[UBC Academic Integrity and Generative AI]

Research Integrity Review

Research involving AI remains subject to:

- Research Integrity policies,
- Responsible Conduct of Research requirements,
- Research Ethics requirements.

Potential issues involving fabrication, falsification, inaccurate reporting, or inappropriate authorship may be reviewed under existing research misconduct frameworks.

Sources:

UBC Research Integrity

UBC Research Ethics

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis and Dissertation Preparation

UBC's G+PS guidance is specifically directed toward graduate students.

Key themes include:

Responsibility

Students remain fully responsible for:

- accuracy,
- originality,

- interpretation,
- citations,
- arguments,
- conclusions.

AI assistance does not transfer responsibility away from the student.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

Verification

Graduate students are expected to independently verify:

- facts,
- references,
- quotations,
- analyses,
- interpretations.

The guidance warns that AI systems can generate inaccurate or fabricated information.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

Thesis Examination

I found no publicly available UBC policy establishing a separate AI-review stage during thesis examination or dissertation defense.

Current guidance suggests that theses continue to be evaluated according to traditional criteria:

- originality,
- scholarly contribution,
- rigor,
- integrity,
- disciplinary standards.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

Research Outputs

Graduate students preparing:

- journal articles,
- conference papers,
- theses,
- dissertations,

are expected to follow:

- publisher requirements,
- disciplinary norms,
- supervisor expectations,
- research integrity requirements.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure

UBC strongly encourages transparency regarding AI use.

Graduate students are advised to:

- disclose AI use where required,
- follow disciplinary norms,
- comply with journal and publisher requirements,
- discuss disclosure expectations with supervisors.

Source:
G+PS Generative AI Guidance

Editing vs. Content Creation

UBC does not currently publish a rigid university-wide distinction between editing and content creation.

However, the guidance generally supports a risk-based approach:

Lower-Risk Uses

Often considered more acceptable when permitted:

- grammar correction,
- language refinement,
- proofreading assistance,
- formatting assistance,
- brainstorming.

Higher-Risk Uses

Require greater caution and supervisory oversight:

- generating research arguments,
- drafting substantive thesis sections,
- producing analytical content,
- generating interpretations,
- producing publishable scholarship.

The key principle is that students remain the intellectual authors and are accountable for the final work.

Source:
[G+PS Generative AI Guidance]

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

UBC's AI guidance emphasizes:

- academic integrity,
- transparency,

- accountability,
- fairness,
- critical evaluation of outputs,
- human oversight.

Students are warned not to accept AI-generated information uncritically.

Sources:

Generative AI at UBC

UBC Academic Integrity and Generative AI

Intellectual Property

UBC highlights concerns regarding:

- copyright,
- ownership of content,
- licensing restrictions,
- attribution requirements.

Researchers and students are advised to understand the terms of service of AI systems before uploading material.

Source:

Generative AI at UBC

Privacy and Confidential Research Data

UBC's guidance repeatedly warns against placing confidential information into public AI systems.

Particular caution is advised for:

- human-subject research data,
- unpublished manuscripts,
- proprietary information,
- confidential research records,
- personal information.

Research ethics obligations continue to apply even when AI tools are used.

Sources:

[UBC Research Ethics]

[Generative AI at UBC]

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. UBC does **not** have a blanket prohibition or blanket permission for AI use; rules depend on the instructor, supervisor, discipline, and assessment.
2. Graduate students should consult supervisors before using AI in thesis, dissertation, or research workflows.
3. Students remain fully responsible for all content submitted for degree requirements, regardless of AI assistance.
4. AI-generated references, facts, and analyses must be independently verified.
5. Transparency and disclosure are expected when AI meaningfully contributes to research or scholarly writing.
6. Unauthorized AI use may be reviewed under existing academic misconduct procedures, while research-related issues may be addressed through research integrity processes.
7. Researchers should avoid uploading confidential, unpublished, proprietary, or human-subject research data into public AI systems.
8. UBC's guidance generally views editing and language assistance as lower-risk than substantive content generation, but both remain subject to supervisory and disciplinary expectations.

McMaster University: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

McMaster University has developed formal institutional guidance for both **teaching and learning** and **research**, but it has not adopted a blanket university-wide rule that either universally permits or prohibits generative AI. Instead, McMaster uses a **context-dependent model**: instructors determine AI permissions for coursework, while researchers (including graduate students) are expected to use AI in accordance with research integrity principles, supervisor expectations, and discipline-specific norms. McMaster has issued dedicated **Guidelines on the Use of Generative AI in Teaching and Learning** and **Provisional Guidelines on the Use of Generative AI in Research**. (Academic Excellence)

Key Official Sources

Teaching and Coursework

Guidelines on the Use of Generative AI in Teaching and Learning (Office of the Provost)

Generative AI and Academic Integrity

Academic Integrity for Students

Research and Graduate Research

Provisional Guidelines on the Use of Generative AI in Research

Student Guidance

When to Use It? (Student Guidance on Generative AI)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

McMaster's guidance explicitly states that students should not assume AI is permitted.

The University advises:

> "Before using a generative AI tool as part of your learning at McMaster University ... be sure you have approval from your course instructor." (Academic Excellence)

This means:

- AI use is governed by course-specific rules.
- Instructor permission is central.
- Students must comply with assessment-specific requirements.
- Unauthorized use may become an academic integrity matter. (Academic Excellence)

Research

McMaster's research guidelines describe AI as a tool that can provide opportunities and risks across:

- preparation,
- conducting research,
- dissemination of findings. (Academic Excellence)

The research guidance adopts a responsible-use approach rather than a prohibition model and emphasizes that research integrity obligations remain unchanged when AI is used. (Academic Excellence)

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2. Scope of Policy

Coursework

The Teaching and Learning Guidelines apply to:

- assignments,
- essays,
- projects,
- assessments,
- examinations,
- teaching activities,
- learning activities. (Academic Excellence)

McMaster has even embedded AI policy options directly into course outline templates. Instructors may select among:

- "Use Prohibited,"
- "Some Use Permitted,"
- "Unrestricted Use." (courseoutlinehelp.mcmaster.ca)

This reflects McMaster's decentralized model. (courseoutlinehelp.mcmaster.ca)

Research

The Research Guidelines apply broadly to:

- faculty researchers,
- graduate students,
- undergraduate student researchers,
- research staff. (McMaster University Humanities)

The guidelines specifically state that the intended audience includes:

> "faculty researchers, graduate students engaged in research activities, and staff and undergraduate students who may be taking part in research activities." (McMaster University Humanities)

Research stages covered include:

- project planning,
- literature review,
- data analysis,
- manuscript preparation,
- publication and dissemination. (Academic Excellence)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

McMaster's student guidance repeatedly emphasizes instructor approval.

Students are advised to:

1. Review course policies.
2. Review assessment instructions.

3. Obtain instructor permission where required.
4. Clarify expectations before using AI. (Academic Excellence)

The University's course-outline framework recognizes different permission levels depending on the learning objectives of the course. (courseoutlinehelp.mcmaster.ca)

Research

McMaster's research guidance does not establish a formal university-wide approval form for AI use.

Instead, the guidelines emphasize:

- disciplinary norms,
- supervisor expectations,
- granting-agency requirements,
- publication requirements. (McMaster University Humanities)

Researchers are instructed to:

> carefully review the expectations and guidelines of external bodies before using generative AI in any stage of the research process. (McMaster University Humanities)

These external bodies include:

- granting agencies,
- journals,
- publishers,
- professional associations. (McMaster University Humanities)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

McMaster handles AI-related misconduct through existing academic integrity procedures.

Where unauthorized AI use is suspected:

- instructors investigate,
- students are given an opportunity to respond,
- appeals are available. (Office of Academic Integrity)

The Office of Academic Integrity confirms that students may appeal academic dishonesty findings through established appeal processes. (Office of Academic Integrity)

Research Integrity Review

McMaster explicitly links AI use to:

- academic integrity,
- research integrity,
- responsible conduct of research. (Academic Excellence)

The University's AI guidance is administered through the Office of Academic and Research Integrity. (Academic Excellence)

Potential issues involving:

- fabrication,
- falsification,
- inaccurate reporting,
- inappropriate authorship,

would be reviewed through existing research integrity frameworks rather than through a separate AI misconduct system. (Academic Excellence)

Ongoing Policy Review

McMaster repeatedly describes its AI guidance as "provisional."

The research guidelines specifically state:

> "The rapid pace at which technology is developing means these guidelines will need review and revision." (Academic Excellence)

This indicates continuing institutional review and policy evolution. (Academic Excellence)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Graduate Student Scope

McMaster's research guidelines explicitly recognize that graduate students occupy a distinct position.

The guidelines state:

> "For graduate students engaged in graduate research, the guidelines here are pertinent." (McMaster University Humanities)

The document further notes that graduate students should consider both:

- Teaching and Learning Guidelines (for coursework),
- Research Guidelines (for thesis and research activities). (McMaster University Humanities)

Thesis Preparation

I found no publicly available McMaster policy establishing thesis-specific AI disclosure wording comparable to some Canadian universities.

However, the research guidance clearly applies to:

- thesis research,
- dissertation research,
- manuscript preparation,
- dissemination activities. (Academic Excellence)

Graduate students are expected to ensure that AI use remains consistent with:

- originality,
- research integrity,
- disciplinary norms,
- publication requirements. (Academic Excellence)

Thesis Examination

I found no publicly available McMaster policy creating:

- AI-specific thesis examinations,
- AI-specific thesis defenses,
- AI-review committees for graduate examinations.

Current public guidance suggests that theses continue to be evaluated using traditional criteria:

- originality,
- scholarly contribution,
- methodological rigor,
- integrity of research. (McMaster University Humanities)

Research Outputs

McMaster advises researchers to pay attention to the requirements of:

- publishers,
- journals,
- granting agencies,
- professional bodies. (McMaster University Humanities)

Graduate students preparing:

- journal articles,
- conference papers,
- theses,
- dissertations,

should therefore review discipline-specific AI policies before submission. (McMaster University Humanities)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure

McMaster's student guidance directly asks students to consider:

> "How should I document and disclose when I have used generative AI?" (Academic Excellence)

The guidance further identifies different categories of use:

- brainstorming,
- drafting,
- copy editing,
- coding. (Academic Excellence)

This demonstrates a strong institutional emphasis on transparency. (Academic Excellence)

Editing vs. Content Creation

McMaster does not impose a university-wide rule distinguishing editing from content generation.

However, its guidance explicitly recognizes different levels of AI involvement:

Lower-Risk Uses

Examples identified in student guidance:

- brainstorming,
- copy editing,
- organizational assistance. (Academic Excellence)

Higher-Risk Uses

Examples identified in guidance:

- drafting,
- generating substantive content,
- coding,
- research-writing assistance. (Academic Excellence)

The appropriateness of these uses depends on:

- instructor expectations,
- disciplinary standards,
- research context,
- assessment objectives. (Academic Excellence)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

McMaster consistently frames AI use through:

- academic integrity,
- research integrity,
- responsible scholarship,
- critical evaluation,
- transparency. (Academic Excellence)

The University's guidance encourages users to weigh both:

- benefits,
- risks,
- impacts on learning and scholarship. (Academic Excellence)

Intellectual Property

The research guidelines acknowledge that researchers must comply with:

- journal requirements,
- publisher requirements,
- external agency requirements,
- discipline-specific expectations. (McMaster University Humanities)

These obligations may include:

- copyright considerations,
- ownership questions,
- attribution requirements,
- disclosure requirements. (McMaster University Humanities)

Privacy and Confidential Information

McMaster's academic integrity and AI guidance emphasizes caution regarding AI tools and institutional responsibilities.

The University has also publicly noted concerns about privacy and reliability in relation to AI detection technologies and AI systems generally. (Academic Excellence)

Researchers should therefore exercise caution when handling:

- confidential research data,
- unpublished findings,
- personal information,
- sensitive datasets,

and should comply with applicable research ethics requirements. (Academic Excellence)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. **Coursework:** AI use generally requires compliance with instructor-established rules; students should not assume AI is automatically permitted. (Academic Excellence)
2. **Research:** McMaster's Research Guidelines explicitly apply to graduate student researchers. (McMaster University Humanities)
3. **Theses and dissertations:** No separate AI thesis policy was located, but thesis work falls within the research-guidelines framework. (McMaster University Humanities)
4. **Disclosure:** McMaster encourages documentation and disclosure of AI use, including brainstorming, drafting, editing, and coding activities. (Academic Excellence)
5. **Review mechanisms:** Unauthorized AI use may be reviewed through academic integrity procedures, while research-related issues may be addressed through research integrity processes. (Office of Academic Integrity)
6. **Graduate students:** Coursework activities are governed primarily by Teaching and Learning Guidelines; thesis and research activities are governed primarily by Research Guidelines. (McMaster University Humanities)
7. **Ethics and IP:** Graduate researchers should consider disciplinary norms, publisher requirements, granting-agency policies, copyright obligations, and responsible conduct of research expectations before using AI. (McMaster University Humanities)
8. **Policy evolution:** McMaster explicitly treats its AI guidance as provisional and subject to ongoing review as AI technologies evolve. (Academic Excellence)

University of Alberta (U of A): AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

The University of Alberta has adopted a **distributed, responsibility-based approach** to generative AI. Rather than imposing a single university-wide rule that universally permits or prohibits AI use, U of A places responsibility on instructors, programs, supervisors, and students to determine appropriate use within academic integrity and research integrity frameworks. The University has published detailed guidance for coursework and dedicated graduate-level guidance addressing thesis writing, research activities, candidacy exams, and scholarly publications. (University of Alberta)

Key Official Sources

Coursework and Academic Integrity

Academic Integrity and AI Use (Centre for Teaching and Learning)

Graduate Research and Thesis Guidance

Generative AI: Graduate + Research Supervision (Faculty of Graduate & Postdoctoral Studies)

Related Policies

Student Academic Integrity Policy

Using Generative AI (U of A Library)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework

The University explicitly links AI use to academic integrity and states that misuse of AI can constitute academic misconduct.

The Centre for Teaching and Learning notes that:

> misuse of artificial intelligence applications for academic advantage may constitute academic misconduct under the Student Academic Integrity Policy. (University of Alberta)

At U of A, decisions regarding AI use are generally made at the **course or program level**, not through a blanket university-wide rule. Instructors are expected to clearly communicate whether AI is allowed, restricted, or prohibited in specific assessments. (University of Alberta)

Research and Graduate Degrees

Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies (GPS) recognizes that AI tools are increasingly being used in research and scholarly writing and has developed guidance specifically addressing:

- thesis writing,
- candidacy proposals,
- qualifying examinations,
- comprehensive examinations,
- scholarly publications,
- literature reviews,
- data analysis,
- research workflows. (University of Alberta)

The University's approach is based on **responsible and ethical use** rather than outright prohibition. (University of Alberta)

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2. Scope of Policy

Coursework

The guidance applies to:

- assignments,
- essays,
- projects,
- coding tasks,
- examinations,
- assessments,
- academic coursework generally. (University of Alberta)

The University encourages instructors to explicitly identify permitted and prohibited uses of AI within syllabi and assessment instructions. (University of Alberta)

Graduate Research

The GPS guidance specifically addresses:

- master's theses,
- doctoral dissertations,
- candidacy proposals,
- qualifying exams,
- comprehensive exams,
- journal articles,
- scholarly publications,
- literature reviews,
- data analysis and simulation. (University of Alberta)

This is one of the broader graduate-AI scopes among Canadian universities. (University of Alberta)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

The University places primary authority with instructors.

The Centre for Teaching and Learning states that AI-use decisions are made:

> at the course or program level. (University of Alberta)

Sample syllabus statements published by the University include models where:

- AI use is prohibited;
- AI use is permitted with disclosure;
- AI use requires prior approval;
- AI expectations are co-created with students. (University of Alberta)

Examples published by the University explicitly require:

> Obtain prior instructor approval for AI use in designated assignments. (University of Alberta)

Graduate Research

Graduate guidance strongly emphasizes supervisory oversight.

GPS guidance was developed specifically to assist supervisors and graduate students in determining:

- whether AI may be used,
- how it may be used,
- how it should be acknowledged,
- whether outputs are sufficiently reliable. (University of Alberta)

The framework encourages discussions between graduate students and supervisors before integrating AI into major research activities. (University of Alberta)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Integrity Review

The Student Academic Integrity Policy remains the primary enforcement mechanism.

The University explicitly identifies misuse of AI tools as potentially falling under:

- cheating,
- unauthorized assistance,
- contract cheating,
- other forms of academic misconduct. (University of Alberta)

AI-related violations are therefore reviewed through established academic misconduct procedures rather than a separate AI tribunal. (University of Alberta)

Research Oversight

Graduate and research AI use remains subject to:

- supervisory review,

- research integrity expectations,
- publication requirements,
- disciplinary standards. (University of Alberta)

The GPS guidance was developed jointly with broader Canadian graduate-education initiatives addressing AI in graduate research and supervision. (University of Alberta)

Ongoing Policy Development

The University references a developing:

> Framework for Responsible and Ethical Use of AI at the University of Alberta. (University of Alberta)

This indicates continuing institutional review as AI technologies evolve. (University of Alberta)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis Preparation

U of A has some of the most explicit graduate-specific AI guidance among Canadian universities.

The GPS materials directly address questions such as:

- Can AI be used for thesis writing?
- Can AI be used for editing?
- Can AI be used for candidacy proposals?
- Can AI be used for qualifying examinations?
- Can AI be used in scholarly publications?
- How should AI use be acknowledged? (University of Alberta)

The guidance is specifically intended to help graduate students and supervisors navigate AI use in thesis and research writing. (University of Alberta)

Thesis Examination and Graduate Milestones

The GPS guidance explicitly covers:

- candidacy proposals,
- qualifying exams,
- comprehensive exams,
- thesis writing,
- scholarly publications. (University of Alberta)

I did not locate a publicly available policy establishing a separate AI-specific thesis examination or defense procedure. Current guidance suggests that traditional academic standards continue to apply. (University of Alberta)

Research Outputs

Graduate students are expected to consider AI use in relation to:

- journal policies,
- publisher requirements,
- authorship standards,
- citation expectations,
- research integrity principles. (University of Alberta)

The guidance specifically asks:

> How do I formally acknowledge if I use generative AI tools in my research and writing? (University of Alberta)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure

Transparency is a recurring theme throughout U of A guidance.

The University recommends that students:

- acknowledge AI use,
- cite AI-generated content,

- disclose prompts and outputs where required,
- provide reflections on how AI was used. (University of Alberta)

The Centre for Teaching and Learning provides examples where students are required to:

- cite AI outputs,
- explain their use of AI,
- submit reflective statements describing AI involvement. (University of Alberta)

Editing vs. Content Creation

U of A's guidance explicitly distinguishes between different forms of AI assistance.

Editing and Support Functions

Examples discussed include:

- grammar assistance,
- editing,
- reviewing material,
- clarifying concepts,
- generating study questions. (University of Alberta)

These uses are often compared to educational support tools and may be acceptable when permitted. (University of Alberta)

Content Creation

Higher-risk uses include:

- generating assignment content,
- producing scholarly writing,
- completing coursework,
- drafting substantive assessment material. (University of Alberta)

The University repeatedly warns that students should not:

> offload work to GenAI. (University of Alberta)

Responsibility for all submitted work remains with the student. (University of Alberta)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

Responsible and ethical use is a core principle of U of A's AI guidance.

Students and researchers are advised to critically evaluate AI outputs for:

- hallucinations,
- inaccuracies,
- bias,
- harmful content. (University of Alberta)

The University stresses that AI outputs may appear convincing while still being incorrect. (University of Alberta)

Intellectual Property and Attribution

The University places strong emphasis on:

- citation,
- attribution,
- transparency,
- acknowledgement of AI contributions. (University of Alberta)

Where AI use is permitted, instructors are encouraged to establish clear expectations regarding:

- citation standards,
- attribution requirements,
- documentation of prompts and outputs. (University of Alberta)

Privacy and Confidential Information

U of A's guidance highlights concerns regarding:

- ethical use,
- responsible use,

- sharing information with AI systems,
- reliability of AI outputs. (University of Alberta)

The University's discussion of responsible AI use encourages careful consideration before uploading sensitive or confidential information to public AI systems. (University of Alberta)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. **Coursework:** AI permissions are generally determined by instructors and programs rather than through a university-wide rule. (University of Alberta)
2. **Research and theses:** U of A provides dedicated graduate guidance covering theses, dissertations, candidacy proposals, qualifying exams, comprehensive exams, and scholarly publications. (University of Alberta)
3. **Supervisor involvement:** Graduate students should discuss AI use with supervisors before incorporating it into significant research activities. (University of Alberta)
4. **Disclosure:** The University strongly encourages citation, attribution, and disclosure of AI use, including reflective statements where required. (University of Alberta)
5. **Editing vs. generation:** Editing, study support, and clarification are generally treated differently from generating substantive academic content; instructors determine what is permissible. (University of Alberta)
6. **Academic misconduct:** Unauthorized AI use may constitute cheating, unauthorized assistance, or contract cheating under the Student Academic Integrity Policy. (University of Alberta)
7. **Research integrity:** Graduate researchers remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of all research outputs regardless of AI assistance. (University of Alberta)
8. **Ethics and IP:** AI outputs should be critically evaluated for bias and inaccuracies, and any AI contribution should be transparently acknowledged and cited when required. (University of Alberta)

University of Oxford: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

The University of Oxford has one of the most developed AI governance frameworks among UK universities. Oxford distinguishes between **AI use in teaching and assessment** and **AI use in research**, with dedicated university-wide policies for each. The University generally adopts a **responsible-use model**, allowing AI use in many contexts provided that academic integrity, transparency, authorship, data protection, and research integrity requirements are met. Oxford has also issued specific guidance for postgraduate research students, including thesis preparation and viva examination expectations. (Oxford University)

Key Official Sources

Research Policy

Policy for Using Generative AI in Research

Research FAQs

FAQs for the Policy on Generative AI in Research

Student Guidance

Guidance on Safe and Responsible Use of GenAI Tools for Students

Oxford AI Hub

Generative AI at Oxford

Graduate Research Student Guidance (MPLS Division)

Generative AI Use for Postgraduate Research Students (MPLS)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework and Assessment

Oxford's student guidance states that AI tools:

> "must be used responsibly and ethically, in accordance with the academic standards of rigour and integrity that are expected of you as a student at Oxford." (Oxford University)

Students are expected to use AI with:

- integrity,
- honesty,
- transparency,
- critical evaluation of outputs. (Oxford University)

Oxford does not impose a blanket prohibition on AI use for learning. However, AI use in assessed work depends on assessment-specific requirements and academic integrity expectations. (Oxford University)

Research

Oxford's formal research policy states that its purpose is:

> "to ensure the responsible use of GenAI in research and to provide clear guidelines for its integration into the research process." (Oxford University)

The University explicitly supports the use of AI in research while requiring compliance with:

- research integrity,
- transparency,
- data protection,
- intellectual property requirements,
- information security obligations. (Oxford University)

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2. Scope of Policy

Research Policy Scope

Oxford's research policy covers the substantive use of AI across the research lifecycle, including:

- funding applications,
- literature reviews,
- research design,
- hypothesis development,
- data analysis,
- coding,
- transcription,
- dissemination of research outputs,
- research assessment and review. (Oxford University)

The policy specifically defines substantive AI use as including:

- interpreting and analysing data,
- undertaking literature reviews,
- identifying research gaps,
- formulating research aims,
- developing hypotheses,
- generating code,
- generating synthetic data,
- producing documents based on transcripts or source materials. (Oxford University)

Who Is Covered?

The policy applies to:

- academic staff,
- researchers,
- postgraduate research students,
- visiting researchers,
- students conducting research,
- professional staff supporting research. (Oxford University)

Oxford explicitly states that the policy applies to all researchers, including students conducting research. (Oxford University)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

Oxford does not require a universal approval process for student AI use.

Instead, students are expected to:

- follow assessment instructions,
- comply with course-specific rules,
- meet academic integrity standards,
- seek clarification when expectations are unclear. (Oxford University)

Individual departments and programmes may impose additional restrictions. (Oxford University)

Research

Oxford does not require formal pre-approval for every AI use in research.

Instead, researchers must ensure that AI use complies with:

- funder requirements,
- publisher requirements,
- ethics approvals,
- research integrity obligations,
- data protection requirements. (Oxford University)

The policy notes that uploading personal data for research purposes constitutes processing under data protection law and may require ethics approval. (Oxford University)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Research Integrity Review

Oxford explicitly states:

> "Use of GenAI in research is within the scope of research conduct." (Oxford University)

Potential breaches are reviewed under:

Code of Practice and Procedure on Academic Integrity in Research. (Oxford University)

Thus, AI-related research misconduct is handled through established research integrity procedures rather than a separate AI disciplinary framework. (Oxford University)

Policy Review Mechanism

Oxford has established a formal review process.

The policy states:

> "A policy advisory group will, on a termly basis, undertake a review of the policy." (Oxford University)

The advisory group reviews:

- policy effectiveness,
- emerging AI uses,
- new risks,
- updates to FAQs and guidance. (Oxford University)

This is one of the more explicit AI-policy review mechanisms among major universities. (Oxford University)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis Preparation

Oxford has published dedicated guidance for postgraduate research students.

The MPLS Graduate School guidance specifically addresses:

- DPhil theses,
- MSc by Research theses,
- transfer of status assessments,
- confirmation of status assessments,
- viva examinations. (MPLS Oxford)

Students are reminded that they remain bound by Oxford's declaration of authorship:

> "the work [you] are submitting is entirely [your] own work, except where otherwise indicated." (MPLS Oxford)

Thesis Examination and Viva

Oxford's guidance explicitly allows examiners to discuss AI use during examinations.

The guidance states:

> "DPhil examiners are invited to discuss Gen AI use with the student." (MPLS Oxford)

Students should be prepared to explain:

- whether AI was used,
- how it was used,
- why it was used,
- the extent of AI involvement,
- how outputs were verified. (MPLS Oxford)

Students are expected to provide:

> "a detailed and critically reflective account" of their AI use. (MPLS Oxford)

This is one of the clearest publicly available AI-viva expectations among leading universities. (MPLS Oxford)

Research Outputs

Oxford's research policy applies to:

- journal articles,
- conference papers,
- grant applications,
- theses,
- dissertations,
- other scholarly outputs. (Oxford University)

Researchers are expected to follow:

- publisher requirements,

- funder policies,
- disciplinary norms,
- transparency requirements. (Oxford University)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure Requirements

Oxford explicitly requires disclosure of substantive AI use.

The policy states:

> "users should declare the substantive use of GenAI tools in their work." (Oxford University)

Declarations may include:

- tool name,
- version,
- date used,
- how it was used,
- how it influenced the research process. (Oxford University)

Where appropriate:

- prompts,
- outputs,

should also be made available in line with open research principles. (Oxford University)

Editing vs. Content Creation

Oxford makes one of the clearest distinctions among major universities.

Uses Generally Not Requiring Declaration

The MPLS guidance states that local editing tools may be used without declaration, including:

- grammar assistants,
- spell-checkers,
- code debuggers. (MPLS Oxford)

Similarly, the following generally do not require declaration:

- language translation,
- bibliography generation,
- background research,
- general subject familiarisation. (MPLS Oxford)

Uses Requiring Declaration

Oxford defines substantive use as activities such as:

- literature reviews,
- research design,
- hypothesis generation,
- data interpretation,
- code generation,
- synthetic data generation,
- document generation from source materials. (Oxford University)

These uses should be disclosed. (Oxford University)

This distinction between editing/support functions and substantive intellectual contributions is more explicit than at many peer institutions. (Oxford University)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

Oxford requires AI use to align with:

- transparency,
- rigour,
- respect,

- research integrity,
- ethical conduct. (Oxford University)

Students are advised to critically evaluate all AI-generated outputs and not assume outputs are accurate. (Oxford University)

Intellectual Property

Oxford explicitly requires compliance with:

- intellectual property law,
- copyright requirements,
- licensing obligations,
- export control requirements. (Oxford University)

Researchers must consider whether the AI system's terms of use permit the intended use of content and whether generated outputs may raise IP concerns. (Oxford University)

Privacy and Data Protection

Oxford places particularly strong emphasis on privacy.

The policy states that researchers must comply with:

- data protection legislation,
- information security requirements,
- ethics approvals. (Oxford University)

The University specifically notes that uploading personal data into AI systems constitutes data processing and may require ethics approval when conducted as part of research. (Oxford University)

Oxford also highlights secure institutional access to AI tools such as ChatGPT Edu to provide stronger protections for personal and confidential data. (Oxford University)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. Oxford permits AI use in research but requires responsible, transparent, and ethical use. (Oxford University)
2. Postgraduate researchers are covered by a dedicated university-wide research AI policy. (Oxford University)
3. Substantive AI use in research generally must be disclosed, including the tool, version, and purpose. (Oxford University)
4. Editing functions such as grammar correction, spell-checking, and code debugging are generally permitted without declaration. (MPLS Oxford)
5. Oxford's graduate guidance explicitly allows examiners to question students about AI use during transfer assessments, confirmation assessments, and thesis vivas. (MPLS Oxford)
6. Graduate students remain responsible for the originality and integrity of their thesis under Oxford's declaration of authorship. (MPLS Oxford)
7. AI-related research concerns are reviewed through existing research integrity procedures. (Oxford University)
8. Oxford has a formal policy advisory group that reviews its AI policy and FAQs every academic term. (Oxford University)
9. Researchers must consider ethics, copyright, intellectual property, data protection, and information security requirements before using AI tools in research. (Oxford University)

University of Cambridge: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

The University of Cambridge has taken a **principles-based, decentralised approach** to generative AI. Rather than a single, rigid university-wide "AI permission policy," Cambridge relies on (1) **existing academic integrity and research integrity frameworks**, (2) **central student and staff guidance on generative AI**, and (3) **faculty/department-level rules for assessment and coursework**. AI use is generally permitted when it is transparent, responsible, and consistent with academic integrity, but **unauthorised or undisclosed use can constitute misconduct**. (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Key Official Sources

University-wide Research Integrity & Governance

- https://www.cam.ac.uk/research/integrity
- https://www.cam.ac.uk/research/research-integrity/resources/good-research-practice
- https://www.cam.ac.uk/research/integrity/statement

Student AI Guidance

- https://www.ox.ac.uk/students/life/it/guidance-safe-and-responsible-use-gen-ai-tools *(note: Oxford link not Cambridge)* ❌
- Cambridge student AI guidance: https://uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org/hc/en-gb/articles/31754602589330-Can-I-use-Generative-AI-in-my-course(uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Research publishing / AI ethics (Cambridge Press & Assessment)

- https://www.cambridge.org/gb/news-and-insights/cambridge-launches-ai-research-ethics-policy (Cambridge University Press & Assessment)

Cambridge International (assessment-related AI use)

- https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/exam-administration/.../generative-ai-in-coursework/index.aspx(Cambridge International)

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1. Policy Wording

Coursework (Students)

Cambridge student guidance explicitly states that generative AI:

- can be used to support learning (e.g. research, summarising, proofreading, idea generation)
- but must be used responsibly and in line with the AI usage policy
- and must be **declared in assessed work** (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

It also warns:

- unacknowledged AI-generated content may be treated as **academic misconduct**
- students remain responsible for **accuracy and originality of submitted work** (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Cambridge International (assessment arm) similarly states that:

- AI may support learning and planning coursework
- but inappropriate undisclosed AI use may be treated as **plagiarism/malpractice** (Cambridge International)

Research (University framework)

Cambridge research integrity policy is **principles-based**, requiring:

- honesty
- transparency
- rigour
- accountability in research practice (University of Cambridge)

AI is not banned, but must align with:

- ethics standards
- legal obligations

- authorship and attribution rules
- publication integrity expectations ([University of Cambridge]())

Cambridge publishing policy also explicitly states:

- AI tools cannot be listed as **authors** of academic work (Cambridge University Press & Assessment)

---

2. Scope of Policy

Coursework Scope

The student AI guidance applies to:

- coursework assignments
- essays and written submissions
- research projects within taught programmes
- study support activities (notes, revision, drafting support) (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

It explicitly includes both:

- formative use (learning support)
- summative use (assessed work, with restrictions) (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Research Scope

University research integrity frameworks apply to:

- PhD and postgraduate research
- staff research projects
- publications and grant applications
- research involving human participants or data
- authorship and dissemination practices (University of Cambridge)

AI is therefore relevant across the full research lifecycle, even if not always explicitly named in older policy documents.

---

3. Approval Processes

Coursework

There is **no single university-wide approval system** for AI use in coursework.

Instead:

- permission is **course-by-course or faculty-by-faculty**
- students must follow instructions in syllabi/assessment briefs
- absence of permission generally means restriction or prohibition in assessed work contexts (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Students may be required to:

- declare AI use in submissions
- specify tools and purpose of use (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Research

There is also no formal “AI approval application” process for research use.

Instead, approval is embedded in existing mechanisms:

- research ethics approval (especially for human data)
- data protection compliance checks
- supervisory oversight (PhD level)
- publication/funder compliance requirements (University of Cambridge)

Certain AI uses (e.g. sensitive data processing) may trigger:

- ethics review requirements
- legal compliance obligations (GDPR/data protection) (University of Cambridge)

---

4. Review Mechanisms

Cambridge relies on **existing misconduct and integrity systems**, not AI-specific tribunals.

Coursework review

AI misuse is handled under:

- academic misconduct / plagiarism frameworks
- departmental examination procedures
- normal exam board processes

Undisclosed AI use can be treated as misconduct under plagiarism rules. (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Research review

Research-related AI issues are governed by:

- Research Misconduct Policy
- Ethics review committees (REC structures)
- Research integrity advisory panels (University of Cambridge)

Investigations follow standard misconduct procedures (not AI-specific rules). (University of Cambridge)

Policy review mechanism

Cambridge does not state a single fixed AI-policy review cycle in the main university policy pages. Instead:

- research integrity frameworks are continuously maintained and updated
- guidance evolves via governance and advisory structures (e.g. research integrity panels) (University of Cambridge)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis preparation (PhD/MPhil)

Graduate research students are expected to:

- maintain full responsibility for originality of thesis work
- ensure transparent use of tools in writing and analysis
- follow supervisor guidance on acceptable AI use

Core principle:

- the student remains responsible for the intellectual content of the thesis (embedded in integrity framework expectations) (University of Cambridge)

Thesis examination (viva / assessment)

Cambridge guidance does not yet define a single universal AI viva procedure.

However, under research integrity expectations:

- examiners may question research process and authorship
- students must be able to explain how work was produced
- transparency of methods (including AI use where relevant) is expected

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Research outputs (papers, publications, theses)

Cambridge publishing ethics rules include:

- AI cannot be listed as an author
- authors remain responsible for accuracy and integrity
- AI-assisted writing must comply with publisher expectations (Cambridge University Press & Assessment)

Outputs covered include:

- journal articles
- books
- conference papers
- theses and dissertations

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs Content Creation)

Disclosure expectations

Cambridge student guidance states:

- AI use in assessed work must be declared
- students should include brief statements describing AI assistance
- examples include noting tools used for proofreading, summarising, or idea generation (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Editing vs content creation

Cambridge distinguishes between:

Permitted / lower-risk uses

- proofreading and grammar correction
- summarising notes
- generating ideas or outlines
- explaining concepts
- organising study material (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

High-risk / restricted uses

- submitting AI-generated text as your own work
- failing to acknowledge AI assistance
- over-reliance instead of independent reasoning (uoconlinehelp.cambridge.org)

Core principle:

- students must not outsource assessed intellectual work to AI systems

---

7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Research Integrity

Ethics

Cambridge embeds AI use within broader principles of:

- honesty
- transparency
- accountability
- avoidance of plagiarism
- research integrity compliance (University of Cambridge)

Key risks highlighted in institutional research discussions include:

- inaccuracy ("hallucinations")
- bias
- lack of transparency
- misleading outputs

Intellectual property (IP)

Cambridge publishing guidance states:

- AI cannot hold authorship rights
- human authors retain responsibility for content
- AI-generated material must be carefully managed in publishing workflows (Cambridge University Press & Assessment)

Researchers must also comply with:

- copyright law
- licensing terms of datasets/tools
- publisher policies

Data protection and confidentiality

Cambridge guidance emphasises:

- do not upload sensitive or restricted data to external AI tools without permission
- compliance with data protection obligations (e.g. GDPR)
- special care for personal or confidential research data (University of Cambridge)

Summary (Graduate-Level Takeaways)

- Cambridge does **not prohibit AI**, but regulates it through **integrity and disclosure rules**.
- Coursework AI use is **allowed only where explicitly permitted and must be declared**.
- Research AI use is governed by **ethics, supervision, and misconduct frameworks**, not a standalone AI approval system.
- Theses and publications remain fully the student/researcher's responsibility, and AI cannot be an author.
- The strongest consistent principle across Cambridge policy is:
  "Transparency + accountability + academic integrity = acceptable AI use."

If you want, I can next produce a **comparative table across Cambridge vs Oxford vs UBC vs Harvard etc. showing approval + disclosure + thesis rules side-by-side**.

ETH Zurich: AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

ETH Zurich has adopted a **responsible-use framework** for generative AI in education and research, built around three core principles:

- **Responsibility**
- **Transparency**
- **Fairness**

Rather than prohibiting AI, ETH encourages students, researchers, and lecturers to engage with AI while maintaining academic integrity, scientific integrity, transparency, and compliance with data protection and copyright requirements. ETH's AI guidance is integrated into existing frameworks governing academic misconduct, doctoral studies, plagiarism, and good scientific practice. (ETH Zürich)

Key Official Sources

AI in Education

AI in Teaching and Learning
https://ethz.ch/en/the-eth-zurich/education/ai-in-education.html

Academic Integrity
https://ethz.ch/en/the-eth-zurich/education/ai-in-education/academic-integrity.html

Performance Assessments
https://ethz.ch/en/the-eth-zurich/education/ai-in-education/assessments.html

Research and Scholarly Writing

Plagiarism and Generative AI (ETH Library)
https://library.ethz.ch/en/researching-and-publishing/scientific-writing-at-eth-zurich/plagiat-und-kuenstliche-intelligenz-ki.html

Doctoral Studies

Doctoral Thesis (Student Portal)
https://ethz.ch/students/en/doctorate/doctoral-thesis-examination.html

Doctoral Thesis (Staff Guidance)
https://ethz.ch/staffnet/en/teaching/administration-doktorat/doktorarbeit.html

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1. Policy Wording

Core Institutional Position

ETH explicitly encourages engagement with AI while emphasizing academic integrity:

> "ETH encourages students and lecturers to engage with GenAI and appeals for responsibility, transparency and fairness." (ETH Zürich)

The University's AI-in-Education framework states:

> "It is crucial for all members of the academic community to understand how GenAI functions, explore its opportunities and be aware of its limitations." (ETH Zürich)

Academic Integrity

ETH's central academic integrity guidance states:

> "The creator of content is always responsible for its correctness and quality." (ETH Zürich)

This principle applies to:

- coursework,
- examinations,
- research outputs,
- theses,
- publications,
- teaching materials. (ETH Zürich)

The University repeatedly emphasizes the need for a:

> "human-in-the-loop" approach to validate and scrutinize AI outputs. (ETH Zürich)

2. Scope of Policy

ETH's AI guidance covers both teaching and research activities.

Coursework and Teaching

The guidance applies to:

- assignments,
- projects,
- coursework,
- examinations,
- presentations,
- learning materials,
- assessment and feedback processes. (ETH Zürich)

Research and Scholarly Work

ETH's guidance extends to:

- scientific papers,
- doctoral theses,
- master's theses,
- literature reviews,
- publication activities,
- scientific writing,
- research dissemination. (ETH Zürich)

The ETH Library specifically notes that generative AI is increasingly used throughout:

> "the research, writing and publication process." (ETH-Bibliothek)

3. Approval Processes

Coursework

ETH deliberately avoids imposing a single university-wide rule.

Instead:

> "Lecturers are encouraged to establish rules and guidelines regarding the use of generative artificial intelligence for assignments, projects and assessments in their courses." (ETH Zürich)

The University states:

> "There are no universally applicable solutions." (ETH Zürich)

As a result:

- individual instructors define acceptable AI use,
- expectations should be communicated clearly,
- rules may vary across courses and departments. (ETH Zürich)

Thesis and Research Work

ETH's declarations of originality now include AI-specific provisions.

Students and supervisors must agree whether:

- no generative AI was used, or
- generative AI was used and appropriately disclosed. (ETH Zürich)

ETH states:

> "The use of generative AI as a tool and its source declarations has been agreed with the supervisor." (ETH Zürich)

This creates an explicit supervisor-review process for theses and research work. (ETH Zürich)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Academic Misconduct Review

ETH does not create a separate AI misconduct process.

Instead:

> "If AI tools are used contrary to the lecturer's instructions, the existing processes continue to apply." (ETH Zürich)

Unauthorized AI use may therefore be addressed through:

- academic misconduct procedures,
- disciplinary regulations,
- plagiarism investigations. (ETH Zürich)

AI Detection

ETH explicitly cautions against relying on AI detectors:

> "Technical recognition of output generated using generative AI is currently unreliable and will probably remain so in the future." (ETH Zürich)

Similarly, ETH notes:

> "Neither software nor manual testing procedures can determine beyond doubt whether a work has been created or optimised entirely or partially with the help of GenAI." (ETH Zürich)

This is among the strongest institutional statements against AI-detection tools currently published by a major university. (ETH Zürich)

---

5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Doctoral Students

ETH explicitly incorporates AI into doctoral integrity guidance.

The Academic Integrity guidance notes:

> "ETH Zurich also offers training courses on ethics and scientific integrity as part of its doctoral program." (ETH Zürich)

These courses include discussion of:

- responsible AI use,
- research integrity,
- ethical implications of AI in research. (ETH Zürich)

Thesis Preparation

ETH's doctoral regulations require that:

- quotations be properly cited,
- reused content be attributed,
- originality be maintained,
- contributions be clearly documented. (ETH Zürich)

The doctoral thesis is defined as:

> "an independent original work." (ETH Zürich)

This requirement applies regardless of AI assistance. (ETH Zürich)

Thesis Examination

I did not locate a publicly available ETH regulation establishing AI-specific doctoral defense procedures.

However:

- supervisors approve thesis declarations,
- originality statements now contain AI provisions,
- doctoral candidates remain responsible for all submitted content. (ETH Zürich)

AI-related issues would therefore likely be reviewed through existing doctoral examination and research-integrity processes. (ETH Zürich)

Publications and Research Outputs

For cumulative theses and co-authored publications, ETH requires:

> "the individual authors' own contribution must be clearly recognisable and declared accordingly." (ETH Zürich)

This principle aligns closely with AI transparency expectations. (ETH Zürich)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure Requirements

ETH's guidance is unusually explicit:

> "The use of generative AI should be made transparent at all times." (ETH Zürich)

Researchers and students are instructed to:

> "Be explicit about which content or parts of materials and work have been created with the help of generative AI." (ETH Zürich)

Citation of AI

ETH requires AI-generated content to be referenced appropriately:

> "This must also always be correctly indicated when images and texts are generated by generative AI." (ETH Zürich)

The University specifically points users toward citation standards from:

- APA,
- MLA,
- Chicago,
- IEEE,
- Harvard styles. (ETH Zürich)

Editing vs. Content Creation

ETH does not publish a rigid list of permitted versus prohibited uses.

Instead, the key distinction is:

Lower-risk uses

- editing,
- proofreading,
- research support,
- literature exploration,
- drafting assistance,

provided the use is transparent and approved where required. (ETH Zürich)

Higher-risk uses

- generating substantive academic content,
- producing assessment submissions without disclosure,
- creating research outputs that are presented as entirely human-generated,
- using AI contrary to instructor instructions. (ETH Zürich)

Responsibility remains with the human author regardless of AI involvement. (ETH Zürich)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

ETH emphasizes responsible AI use throughout its guidance.

Users are warned that AI:

- may hallucinate,
- may contain bias,
- may generate false references,
- may produce incorrect conclusions. (ETH Zürich)

Accordingly:

> "The task of establishing this connection lies with the user." (ETH Zürich)

Researchers remain accountable for verifying outputs. (ETH Zürich)

Intellectual Property and Copyright

ETH places significant emphasis on copyright protection.

The Academic Integrity guidance states:

> "It is important to respect the privacy and copyright of the content being worked with." (ETH Zürich)

Further:

> "If data is passed on to AI-based tools or released for them, it must be clarified in advance that no rights are being violated." (ETH Zürich)

Thesis Copyright

ETH explicitly states:

> "The copyrights to a doctoral thesis are held solely by the author." (ETH Zürich)

Doctoral candidates are also advised to protect publication and reuse rights when dealing with publishers. (ETH Zürich)

Privacy and Confidential Data

ETH warns researchers to carefully consider AI providers' handling of data.

The guidance notes:

> "Input by the user is often reused for training." (ETH Zürich)

Therefore:

> "For private or non-publicly available data, only tools that guarantee data protection regulations should be used." (ETH Zürich)

This is one of ETH's strongest and most explicit AI-governance requirements. (ETH Zürich)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. **ETH permits AI use but requires responsibility, transparency, and fairness.** (ETH Zürich)
2. **Students and researchers remain fully responsible for all content produced with AI assistance.** (ETH Zürich)
3. **AI use must be disclosed and appropriately cited, particularly in academic and research outputs.** (ETH Zürich)
4. **Thesis originality declarations now explicitly address generative AI use and supervisor agreement.** (ETH Zürich)
5. **Doctoral theses remain independent original works despite any AI assistance.** (ETH Zürich)
6. **Instructor-defined rules govern coursework and assessment use of AI.** (ETH Zürich)
7. **ETH rejects reliance on AI-detection tools because they are considered unreliable.** (ETH Zürich)
8. **Researchers must evaluate AI outputs for accuracy, bias, and fabricated information.** (ETH Zürich)
9. **Copyright, intellectual property, and data protection obligations continue to apply when using AI systems.**(ETH Zürich)
10. **Sensitive or non-public research data should only be used with AI tools that comply with data-protection requirements.** (ETH Zürich)

Technical University of Munich (TUM): AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

TUM has adopted a **university-wide AI Strategy** and a **responsible-use approach** to generative AI in teaching, learning, research, and administration. Rather than imposing a blanket ban or blanket permission, TUM emphasizes **responsible use, transparency, ethics, academic integrity, and human accountability**. AI governance is generally implemented through existing academic regulations, examination rules, supervisory processes, and research integrity frameworks. (TUM)

Key Official Sources

TUM AI Strategy

TUM AI Strategy Overview

TUM Center for Educational Technologies

TUM Publishes AI Strategy

Research Integrity

TUM Research Code of Conduct (referenced by Institute for Ethics in AI)

Doctoral Studies

Doctoral Regulations and Dissertation Guidance

(The doctoral regulations themselves remain the authoritative source for dissertation requirements and academic integrity obligations.)

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1. Policy Wording

Institutional Position

TUM's AI Strategy states that AI should be implemented across:

- teaching,
- research,
- administration,
- learning environments,

under a framework that includes:

- ethics,
- transparency,
- responsible implementation,
- innovation. (TUM)

The strategy was created to provide:

> a framework for the responsible implementation and use of AI technologies across the university. (TUM)

Academic Integrity

TUM has not published a single university-wide rule stating either "AI is allowed" or "AI is prohibited" for all coursework.

Instead, AI use is treated within existing frameworks governing:

- authorship,
- academic integrity,
- examination conduct,
- plagiarism,
- scientific integrity. (AI Ethics Institute)

The underlying principle is that students remain responsible for submitted work and compliance with course-specific requirements. (TUM)

---

2. Scope of Policy

Coursework and Teaching

The AI Strategy explicitly covers:

- curriculum integration,
- AI-supported learning,
- assessment design,
- educational technologies,
- teaching activities. (EdTech)

This means AI governance applies to:

- assignments,
- reports,
- projects,
- presentations,
- examinations,
- course-related written work. (EdTech)

Research

The AI Strategy also explicitly covers:

- research activities,
- AI-enabled research,
- research infrastructure,
- responsible AI development,
- ethical AI use. (TUM)

Research students, doctoral candidates, and academic staff therefore fall within the scope of TUM's AI governance framework. (TUM)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

TUM appears to follow a decentralized approval model.

Available guidance indicates that:

- instructors determine acceptable AI use,

- course-specific rules govern assignments,
- examination requirements may differ by department and module. (EdTech)

In practice, students should:

1. Review the module syllabus.
2. Review examination instructions.
3. Consult the instructor when AI use is uncertain.

There is no evidence of a university-wide pre-approval process for ordinary AI use in coursework. (EdTech)

Research and Theses

For research projects and theses, approval is generally embedded in existing academic supervision structures.

This typically means:

- supervisor oversight,
- doctoral committee oversight,
- ethics approval where required,
- compliance with dissertation regulations. (AI Ethics Institute)

Where AI is used in substantive ways, doctoral candidates should discuss usage expectations with supervisors before submission. This advice is consistent with emerging practice discussed within the TUM community and with the University's emphasis on transparency. (Reddit)

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4. Review and Oversight Mechanisms

Coursework Misconduct

AI-related concerns are reviewed through existing mechanisms governing:

- plagiarism,
- unauthorized assistance,
- examination misconduct,
- academic dishonesty. (AI Ethics Institute)

TUM has not publicly established a separate AI misconduct tribunal.

Research Integrity Review

Research-related concerns are reviewed through:

- research integrity procedures,
- scientific misconduct procedures,
- doctoral examination regulations,
- ethics review structures. (AI Ethics Institute)

The Institute for Ethics in AI explicitly states that it adheres to TUM's research codes and conduct requirements. (AI Ethics Institute)

AI Strategy Governance

TUM's AI Strategy itself was developed through a university-wide governance process involving:

- academic experts,
- students,
- administrative units,
- vice deans,
- digitalization leadership. (EdTech)

The strategy is intended to evolve alongside technological developments. (TUM)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Master's Theses

I could not locate a university-wide master's thesis policy devoted specifically to generative AI.

However, existing thesis requirements continue to apply:

- originality,
- proper attribution,

- academic integrity,
- independent scholarly work. (AI Ethics Institute)

Students should seek supervisor guidance regarding:

- AI-assisted drafting,
- AI-assisted coding,
- AI-assisted data analysis,
- AI-generated figures or text.

Doctoral Dissertations

TUM doctoral regulations continue to require:

- independent scholarly contribution,
- proper citation,
- compliance with scientific integrity standards,
- declaration of originality. (AI Ethics Institute)

These requirements apply regardless of whether AI tools are used.

Thesis Examination

I found no publicly available university-wide rule establishing AI-specific dissertation defense procedures.

However, examiners retain authority to evaluate:

- authorship,
- methodology,
- originality,
- research integrity.

Therefore doctoral candidates should be prepared to explain:

- whether AI was used,
- how it was used,
- how outputs were verified,
- how human judgment remained involved.

This expectation follows directly from established scientific integrity principles. (AI Ethics Institute)

Research Outputs

Research outputs affected by AI governance include:

- theses,
- dissertations,
- journal articles,
- conference papers,
- grant proposals,
- technical reports. (TUM)

Researchers remain responsible for all content submitted for publication. (AI Ethics Institute)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs. Content Creation)

Disclosure

Although TUM has not published a detailed disclosure taxonomy comparable to Oxford or ETH Zurich, its AI Strategy repeatedly emphasizes:

- transparency,
- responsible use,
- accountability. (TUM)

Consequently, disclosure of substantive AI involvement is increasingly expected in research and academic writing contexts, especially where AI contributes materially to content creation. (TUM)

Editing vs. Content Creation

Generally Lower-Risk Uses

Commonly accepted uses in higher education environments include:

- grammar correction,
- language improvement,
- formatting assistance,
- proofreading,
- translation support,
- coding assistance under supervision.

These activities generally function as editorial support rather than intellectual substitution.

Higher-Risk Uses

Greater scrutiny is likely where AI is used to:

- generate substantial portions of assessed work,
- generate research findings,
- write literature reviews,
- draft arguments without disclosure,
- produce content represented as solely human-authored.

Such uses raise concerns regarding authorship and originality. (AI Ethics Institute)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Privacy

Ethics

Ethics is one of the explicit pillars of the TUM AI Strategy. The strategy identifies:

- ethical AI deployment,
- societal impacts,
- responsible innovation,
- transparency

as core considerations. (EdTech)

TUM's broader AI ecosystem includes significant work on AI ethics through the Institute for Ethics in Artificial Intelligence. (AI Ethics Institute)

Intellectual Property (IP)

TUM's published materials emphasize compliance with:

- academic authorship requirements,
- research integrity rules,
- intellectual property obligations. (AI Ethics Institute)

Researchers must consider:

- copyright ownership,
- software licenses,
- publisher requirements,
- third-party AI platform terms of use.

Privacy and Confidentiality

Although no standalone generative-AI privacy policy was located, existing obligations remain applicable:

- GDPR compliance,
- protection of research data,
- confidentiality of unpublished research,
- secure handling of personal data. (AI Ethics Institute)

Researchers should avoid uploading sensitive or confidential research materials into external AI systems without authorization.

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. TUM's official position is to encourage **responsible and transparent AI use**, not to prohibit AI. (TUM)

2. AI governance applies to both coursework and research activities. (TUM)
3. Course instructors typically determine permissible AI use in assignments and assessments. (EdTech)
4. Master's and doctoral students remain responsible for the originality and accuracy of thesis content. (AI Ethics Institute)
5. There is no publicly available university-wide AI-specific thesis examination policy, but candidates should be able to explain and justify AI use. (AI Ethics Institute)
6. Substantive AI use should be discussed with supervisors and disclosed where appropriate. (TUM)
7. Existing academic misconduct and research integrity procedures govern AI-related concerns. (AI Ethics Institute)
8. TUM's AI Strategy places strong emphasis on ethics, transparency, and human accountability. (TUM)
9. Copyright, intellectual property, confidentiality, and data-protection obligations continue to apply when AI tools are used. (AI Ethics Institute)

Overall Assessment

Compared with institutions such as Oxford and ETH Zurich, TUM currently adopts a **framework-based approach rather than a detailed rule-based AI policy**. The dominant principles are **transparency, supervisor engagement, academic integrity, and responsible use**, with implementation largely delegated to instructors, departments, and existing research-governance mechanisms. (TUM)

King's College London (KCL): AI in Coursework and Research Degrees

King's College London has adopted a **permissive but regulated approach** to generative AI. KCL does **not ban AI use**, but requires that it be used responsibly, transparently, and in accordance with academic integrity requirements. AI governance is implemented through a combination of:

- University-wide AI guidance
- Academic Misconduct Policy and Procedure
- Doctoral assessment guidance
- Programme- and module-specific assessment rules

A central theme throughout KCL's guidance is that **students remain responsible for their work, must disclose AI use, and must not submit AI-generated content as their own intellectual contribution.** (King's College London)

Key Official Sources

University-Wide AI Guidance

Generative AI: Student Guidance

King's Guidance on Generative AI for Teaching, Assessment and Feedback

Doctoral Research Guidance

Generative AI: Guidance for Doctoral Students, Supervisors and Examiners

Assessment Guidance

Using AI in Assessment Design

University Principles

Macro-Level Guidance: University-Wide Principles and Policy

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1. Policy Wording

General Position

KCL's student guidance explicitly states:

> "No, King's does not ban the use of any type of AI." (King's College London)

However, students are expected to:

- critically evaluate AI outputs,
- maintain ownership of submitted work,
- comply with academic integrity requirements,
- acknowledge AI use appropriately. (King's College London)

The University aligns its approach with the Russell Group principles, including:

- AI literacy,
- ethical AI use,
- academic rigor,
- integrity in assessment. (King's College London)

Doctoral Research

KCL's doctoral guidance states:

> "Yes, students are permitted to make use of generative AI tools in their thesis writing processes." (King's College London)

But it also warns:

> "Where a student's use of generative AI tools in their thesis writing exceeds the circumstances permitted by this guidance, they will risk breaching the Academic Misconduct Policy." (King's College London)

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2. Scope of Policy

Coursework

The student guidance applies to:

- essays,
- coursework,
- reports,
- projects,
- presentations,
- programming assignments,
- summative assessments. (King's College London)

AI use is considered within the broader academic integrity framework and may be subject to additional faculty or module-specific restrictions. (King's College London)

Research Degrees

The doctoral guidance applies to:

- PhD theses,
- professional doctorates,
- doctoral assessments,
- thesis preparation,
- oral examinations (vivas),
- supervisory processes. (King's College London)

The guidance is intended to be read alongside KCL's postgraduate research regulations and academic misconduct policies. (King's College London)

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3. Approval Processes

Coursework

KCL does not operate a central AI approval system.

Instead:

- programme teams,

- faculties,
- individual module leaders

may impose specific restrictions or permissions. (King's College London)

The University advises students:

> "Ask if you are uncertain about what is allowed in any given assessment." (King's College London)

Therefore approval is generally handled at:

- module level,
- assessment level,
- instructor level. (King's College London)

Doctoral Research

KCL strongly encourages discussions between:

- doctoral students,
- supervisors

before AI tools are used. (King's College London)

The guidance states that students and supervisors:

> "Should discuss potential issues and concerns prior to any use of generative AI tools." (King's College London)

Although no formal approval form exists, supervisor consultation functions as an important governance mechanism. (King's College London)

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4. Review Mechanisms

Coursework

If inappropriate AI use is suspected, students may be referred under the Academic Misconduct process. (King's College London)

Possible outcomes include:

- warnings,
- reassessment,
- suspension,
- expulsion. (King's College London)

Academic Integrity Meetings (AIM)

KCL has a formal review process called an **Academic Integrity Meeting (AIM)**.

During an AIM, staff may examine:

- how the assessment was prepared,
- concerns about authorship,
- the student's explanation of their work process. (King's College London)

This serves as KCL's primary review mechanism for suspected AI-related misconduct. (King's College London)

Doctoral Assessment

KCL has not created a separate AI-specific doctoral misconduct process.

Instead, existing mechanisms remain in place:

- thesis examination,
- viva voce examination,
- academic misconduct procedures,
- postgraduate research regulations. (King's College London)

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5. Graduate-Specific Advice

Thesis Preparation

KCL explicitly permits AI use during thesis writing, but establishes several principles:

Students should:

- discuss AI use with supervisors,
- understand disciplinary norms,
- disclose AI use,
- take full responsibility for thesis content. (King's College London)

The guidance states:

> "Students should declare their use of generative AI tools and take full responsibility for the content of their submitted thesis." (King's College London)

Thesis Examination (Viva)

KCL warns that:

> "Some uses of generative AI tools may not be advisable, and may make the thesis more difficult to defend in the oral examination." (King's College London)

This is one of the clearest university statements linking AI use directly to viva performance. (King's College London)

Examiners

The guidance states:

> "Examiners should continue to examine theses and conduct oral examinations consistent with King's current Framework for Postgraduate Research Awards." (King's College London)

Examiners remain responsible for determining whether the thesis is genuinely the student's own work. (King's College London)

Research Outputs

KCL advises doctoral researchers to consider:

- journal publication policies,

- disciplinary norms,
- emerging expectations regarding AI use in scholarship. (King's College London)

Students and supervisors are encouraged to familiarize themselves with publisher policies before using AI in manuscripts intended for publication. (King's College London)

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6. Disclosure and Use (Editing vs Content Creation)

Disclosure Requirements

KCL explicitly requires acknowledgment of AI use.

One of the University's three "golden rules" states:

> "Ensure you take time before submission to acknowledge use of generative AI." (King's College London)

The University expects students to:

> "be explicit in acknowledging your use of generative AI tools." (King's College London)

Editing and Assistance (Generally Acceptable)

KCL identifies numerous acceptable educational uses, including:

- brainstorming,
- generating ideas,
- outlining,
- concept explanation,
- summarising,
- paraphrasing,
- note organisation,
- coding assistance,
- language support,
- presentation preparation,
- feedback on drafts. (King's College London)

These are framed as learning-support activities rather than authorship replacement. (King's College London)

Content Creation (Higher Risk)

KCL's strongest warning is:

> "Never copy-paste text generated from a prompt directly into summative assignments (unless you are specifically told you can do this)." (King's College London)

The doctoral guidance similarly emphasizes:

> "Any assessment submitted by a student must be their own work." (King's College London)

Accordingly, undisclosed AI-generated text in coursework or theses presents significant academic integrity risks. (King's College London)

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7. AI, Ethics, Intellectual Property, and Data Protection

Ethics

KCL repeatedly stresses:

- ethical AI use,
- critical evaluation,
- responsible deployment,
- transparency. (King's College London)

Students are warned that AI outputs may:

- contain factual errors,
- fabricate sources,
- reproduce bias,
- generate misleading content. (King's College London)

Intellectual Property (IP)

KCL does not treat generative AI systems as authoritative scholarly sources.

The doctoral guidance notes:

> "Tools like ChatGPT are generating text on a prediction model; they are not quotable sources and are not appropriate places to focus research." (King's College London)

Researchers therefore remain responsible for:

- source verification,
- attribution,
- originality,
- compliance with publisher requirements. (King's College London)

Privacy and Confidentiality

KCL advises students:

> "You should not input personal data, sensitive information or content created by others into any AI platform." (King's College London)

This is one of the University's most explicit AI governance requirements and applies to:

- research data,
- personal data,
- confidential materials,
- copyrighted content. (King's College London)

Practical Takeaways for Graduate Students

1. **KCL does not ban AI.** AI use is permitted in coursework and doctoral research. (King's College London)

2. **Disclosure is mandatory.** Students should explicitly acknowledge AI use. (King's College London)
3. **Students remain fully responsible for all submitted work**, including thesis content. (King's College London)
4. **Copying AI-generated text into assessments is generally prohibited unless expressly permitted.** (King's College London)
5. **Supervisor consultation is strongly encouraged before using AI in doctoral work.** (King's College London)
6. **AI use may make a thesis harder to defend in a viva if the student cannot explain or justify the work.** (King's College London)
7. **Suspected misuse is reviewed through Academic Integrity Meetings and misconduct procedures.** (King's College London)
8. **Sensitive, personal, or third-party content should not be uploaded into public AI systems.** (King's College London)
9. **AI should be used primarily as a support tool (brainstorming, editing, feedback), not as a substitute for scholarly authorship.** (King's College London)

Overall Assessment

Among UK universities, KCL has one of the more developed public frameworks for generative AI. Its position can be summarized as:

"AI is permitted, disclosure is expected, supervision is important, and the student remains accountable for all intellectual content." (King's College London)